

Pulp Fiction

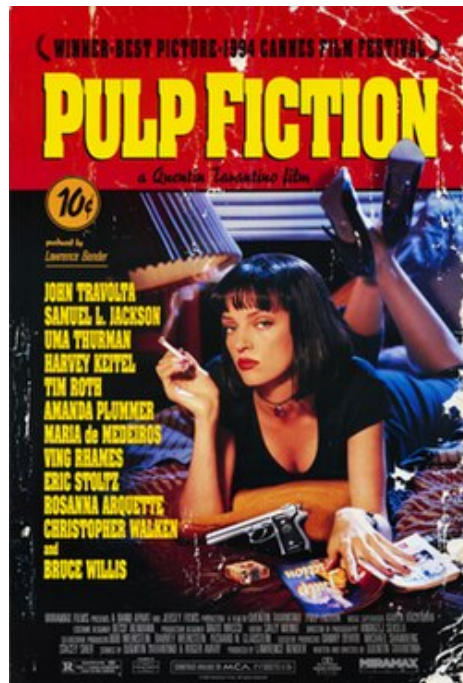
Pulp Fiction is a 1994 American crime film written and directed by Quentin Tarantino from a story he conceived with Roger Avary.^[3] It tells four intertwining tales of crime and violence in Los Angeles. The film stars John Travolta, Samuel L. Jackson, Bruce Willis, Tim Roth, Ving Rhames, and Uma Thurman. The title refers to the pulp magazines and hardboiled crime novels popular during the mid-twentieth century, known for their graphic violence and punchy dialogue.

Tarantino wrote *Pulp Fiction* in 1992 and 1993, incorporating scenes that Avary originally wrote for *True Romance* (1993). Its plot occurs out of chronological order. The film features self-referential elements, monologues, casual conversations with eclectic dialogue, and an ironic combination of humor and violence. TriStar Pictures turned down the script as "too demented". Miramax Films co-chairman Harvey Weinstein was enthralled, however, and the film became the first that Miramax Films fully financed.

Pulp Fiction premiered at the 1994 Cannes Film Festival where it won the Palme d'Or, and was a major critical and commercial success. It received seven nominations at the 67th Academy Awards, including Best Picture, and won Best Original Screenplay; Travolta, Jackson, and Thurman were nominated for Best Actor, Best Supporting Actor, and Best Supporting Actress respectively. As a result of the film's success, Travolta's career was reinvigorated. The film's development, marketing, distribution, and profitability had a sweeping effect on independent cinema.

Pulp Fiction is regarded as Tarantino's *magnum opus*, with particular praise for its screenwriting.^[4] The self-reflexivity, unconventional structure, and extensive homage and pastiche have led critics to describe it as a touchstone of postmodern film. It is considered a cultural watershed, influencing films and other media that adopted elements of its style. The cast was also widely praised, with Travolta, Thurman, and Jackson earning high acclaim. In 2008, *Entertainment Weekly* named it the best film since 1983^[5] and it has appeared on many critics' lists of the greatest films. In 2013, *Pulp Fiction* was selected for preservation in the United States National Film Registry by the Library of Congress as "culturally, historically, or aesthetically significant".^{[6][7][8]}

Pulp Fiction



Theatrical release poster

Directed by	<u>Quentin Tarantino</u>
Written by	<u>Quentin Tarantino</u>
Story by	<u>Quentin Tarantino</u> <u>Roger Avary</u>
Produced by	<u>Lawrence Bender</u>
Starring	<u>John Travolta</u> <u>Samuel L. Jackson</u> <u>Uma Thurman</u> <u>Harvey Keitel</u> <u>Tim Roth</u> <u>Amanda Plummer</u> <u>Maria de Medeiros</u> <u>Ving Rhames</u> <u>Eric Stoltz</u> <u>Rosanna Arquette</u> <u>Christopher Walken</u> <u>Bruce Willis</u>
Cinematography	<u>Andrzej Sekuła</u>
Edited by	<u>Sally Menke</u>

Narrative structure

Pulp Fiction follows a nonlinear narrative structure with several plot lines that intersect at various points. Its structure is spliced into 7 parts, which are listed below. Bolded sections are those explicitly referenced in the film's title cards.

1. "Prologue – The Diner" (I)
2. "Prelude to 'Vincent Vega and Marsellus Wallace's Wife' "
3. **"Vincent Vega and Marsellus Wallace's Wife"**
4. "Prelude to 'The Gold Watch' "
5. **"The Gold Watch"**
6. **"The Bonnie Situation"**
7. "Epilogue – The Diner" (II)

If the seven sequences were ordered chronologically, they would run: 4, 2, 6, 1, 7, 3, 5. Sequences 1 and 7 partially overlap and are presented from different points of view, as do sequences 2 and 6. According to Philip Parker, the structural form is "an episodic narrative with circular events adding a beginning and end and allowing references to elements of each separate episode to be made throughout the narrative".^[9] Other analysts describe the structure as a "circular narrative".^{[10][11]}

Plot

A young Butch Coolidge is visited by Captain Koons, an Air Force pilot. Koons reveals a gold watch to Butch and explains that the watch is a family heirloom and belonged to Butch's father, who served with Koons and died in a POW camp in the Vietnam War. Koons continues the tradition by giving the watch to Butch.

Years later in Los Angeles, two hitmen, Jules Winnfield and Vincent Vega, drive to an apartment to retrieve a briefcase from Brett, a dishonest business partner for their boss, gangster Marsellus Wallace. Vincent mentions that Marsellus has instructed him to take his wife, Mia, to dinner the following night. At the apartment, they find Brett, Roger and an informant for Marsellus, Marvin. When Brett attempts to appease the two hitmen, Jules casually shoots Roger. He then recites a paraphrased passage from the Book of Ezekiel before he and Vincent kill Brett. Another man bursts out of the bathroom and fires at them, but misses every shot. Jules and Vincent kill him and leave with the briefcase and Marvin.

While Jules is driving, Vincent accidentally shoots Marvin in the head, covering them in blood. They hide the car at the home of Jules' friend Jimmie, who demands they dispose of Marvin's corpse and the blood-stained car before his wife, Bonnie, comes home. Marsellus sends a cleaner, Winston Wolfe, who directs Jules and Vincent to hide the body in the trunk, clean the car, dispose of their bloody clothes and take the car to a junkyard. Afterwards, Jules and Vincent eat breakfast at a diner. Jules tells Vincent that he plans to retire from his life of crime, convinced that their survival at the apartment was divine intervention.

While Vincent is in the bathroom, a pair of thieves, Pumpkin and Honey Bunny, hold up the diner and demand Marsellus' briefcase from Jules. Jules overpowers Pumpkin and holds him at gunpoint, making Honey Bunny hysterical. She points her gun at Jules; Vincent returns and points his gun at her. Jules defuses the situation, allowing the two to keep the money from only his wallet and letting them leave.

Production companies	<u>A Band Apart</u> <u>Jersey Films</u>
Distributed by	<u>Miramax Films</u>
Release dates	May 21, 1994 (<u>Cannes</u>) October 14, 1994 (<u>United States</u>)
Running time	154 minutes ^[1]
Country	United States
Language	English
Budget	\$8–8.5 million ^{[2][a]}
Box office	\$213.9 million ^[2]

Jules and Vincent meet Marsellus at a bar, where Marsellus is bribing an aging Butch to intentionally lose in his upcoming boxing match. The following night, Vincent purchases heroin from his drug dealer, Lance. He shoots up and drives to meet Mia at her house. They eat at a 1950s-themed restaurant and participate in a twist contest, then return home. While Vincent is in the bathroom, Mia finds his heroin, mistakes it for cocaine, and snorts it. She passes out from an overdose, and Vincent rushes her to Lance's house, where they revive her by injecting her heart with adrenaline. Vincent and Mia agree never to tell Marsellus about the incident.

Butch double-crosses Marsellus by killing his opponent. He plans to flee with his girlfriend, Fabienne, but discovers that she has forgotten to pack the gold watch. Returning to his apartment to retrieve it, he notices a gun on the kitchen counter and hears the toilet flush. Vincent, who has been staking out Butch's apartment, emerges from the bathroom. Butch kills him with the gun and leaves. While returning to the motel, he sees Marsellus crossing the road. Marsellus chases Butch into a pawnshop. Maynard, the shop owner, captures them at gunpoint and gags them in the basement. Maynard and his accomplice, Zed, take Marsellus into another room and rape him. Butch breaks free and kills Maynard with a katana, freeing Marsellus who incapacitates Zed. Marsellus instructs Butch to tell no one about the incident and leave Los Angeles forever while he himself intends to "get medieval" on Zed. Butch picks up Fabienne on Zed's motorcycle.

Cast

Main characters

- John Travolta as Vincent Vega: Jules's partner-in-crime, working for Marsellus Wallace. Tarantino cast Travolta in *Pulp Fiction* because Michael Madsen, who had played Vic Vega in *Reservoir Dogs* (1992), chose to appear in Kevin Costner's Wyatt Earp instead. Madsen expressed regret over his decision.^[12] Harvey Weinstein pushed for Daniel Day-Lewis in the part.^[13] Travolta accepted a reduced rate; sources say either US\$100,000 or US\$140,000. The film's success and his Academy Award nomination for Best Actor revitalized his career.^[14] Vincent is the brother of Vic Vega, also known as Mr. Blonde in *Reservoir Dogs*, and in 2004, Tarantino discussed an idea for a movie starring Travolta and Madsen as the "Vega Brothers", though the concept never came to fruition.^[15]
- Samuel L. Jackson as Jules Winnfield: Vincent's partner-in-crime, working for Marsellus Wallace. Jackson's first audition was overshadowed by Paul Calderón; Jackson had assumed the audition was merely a reading. Weinstein convinced him to audition a second time and his performance of the final diner scene won over Tarantino.^{[16][17]} Jules was originally scripted with a giant afro,^[18] but Tarantino's personal assistant mistakenly bought a Jheri curled wig. Tarantino was enraged but Jackson persuaded him to keep it since the hairstyle had gained popularity through the rap group N.W.A.^[19] Film critic Owen Gleiberman took it as a "tacit comic statement about the ghettoization of [Black people] in movies".^[20] Jackson received an Oscar nomination for Best Supporting Actor. Calderón appears in the film as Paul, a bartender at Marsellus's social club, as well as Marsellus's assistant. Tarantino wrote the role for Laurence Fishburne, who turned it down. According to Tarantino, Fishburne refused it because his team did not see it as a starring role;^[21] Fishburne later said he turned it down because he felt the film glamorized heroin.^[22] Eddie Murphy was also considered.^[23]
- Uma Thurman as Mia Wallace: Marsellus Wallace's wife and an aspiring actress. Miramax favored Holly Hunter or Meg Ryan for the role of Mia. Robin Wright, Jennifer Beals, Debra Winger, Marisa Tomei, Alfre Woodard and Meg Tilly were also considered but Tarantino wanted Thurman after their first meeting.^{[24][25][23]} She dominated the film's promotional material, appearing on a bed with cigarette in one hand and pulp novel in the other. She was nominated for an Oscar for Best Supporting Actress. Despite being launched into the celebrity A-list, Thurman chose not to do any big-budget films until *Batman & Robin* (1997) three years later.^[26]
- Bruce Willis as Butch Coolidge: An aging boxer on the run from Marsellus after having double-crossed him. The role was originally written for Matt Dillon, who turned it down.^[27] Mickey Rourke also turned down the role.^[28] Willis was already a star but most of his recent films had been critical

and box-office disappointments. As related by Peter Bart, participating in the modestly budgeted film "meant lowering his salary and risking his star status but the strategy paid off royally: *Pulp Fiction* not only brought Willis new respect as an actor but also earned him several million dollars".^{[29][30][31]} Willis' appearance and physical presence were crucial to Tarantino, "Bruce has the look of a '50s actor. I can't think of any other star that has that look".^[32] Butch's look was modeled on Aldo Ray in *Nightfall* and his demeanor based on Ralph Meeker's portrayal of Mike Hammer in Robert Aldrich's *Kiss Me Deadly*.^[33] Chandler Lindauer plays a young Butch.

- Harvey Keitel as Winston Wolfe: A "cleaner" who aids Jules and Vincent. Tarantino wrote the part of Wolfe for Keitel, who had starred in *Reservoir Dogs* and was instrumental in its production. In Tarantino's words, "Harvey had been my favorite actor since I was 16 years old."^[34] Keitel had played a similarly employed character in *Point of No Return* (1993).^[35]
- Tim Roth as Ringo/"Pumpkin": A robber and Yolanda's boyfriend. Roth had starred in *Reservoir Dogs* alongside Keitel. He had used an American accent in *Reservoir Dogs* but used his natural, London accent in *Pulp Fiction*. Though Tarantino had written the part with Roth in mind, TriStar head Mike Medavoy preferred Johnny Depp or Christian Slater.^[36] Early in development, Tarantino had contemplated casting Roth as Vincent and Gary Oldman as Jules, rewriting the characters as "two English guys".^[37]
- Amanda Plummer as Yolanda/"Honey Bunny": Ringo's girlfriend and partner in crime. Tarantino wrote the role of Yolanda for Plummer to partner her with Roth. Roth had introduced Tarantino to her, saying: "I want to work with Amanda in one of your films but she has to have a really big gun."^[38]
- Maria de Medeiros as Fabienne: Butch's girlfriend. Tarantino met de Medeiros, a Portuguese actress, while traveling with *Reservoir Dogs* around the European film festival circuit.^[39]
- Ving Rhames as Marsellus Wallace: A crime boss and employer of Jules and Vincent. Before Rhames was cast, the part of Wallace was initially offered to Max Julien and Sid Haig, but both turned down the role.^{[40][41]} According to Bender, Rhames gave "one of the best auditions I've ever seen".^[25] His acclaimed performance led to him being cast in big-budget features such as *Mission Impossible* (1996), *Con Air* (1997) and *Out of Sight* (1998).^[42]
- Eric Stoltz as Lance: Vincent's drug dealer.^[43] Tarantino initially wrote the role with John Cusack in mind.^[23] Gary Oldman was the preferred choice among TriStar executives, based on his portrayal of drug-dealing pimp Drexel Spivey in *True Romance* (1993).^{[44][45]}
- Rosanna Arquette as Jody: Lance's wife. Pam Grier read for the role, but Tarantino did not believe audiences would find it plausible for Lance to yell at her.^[46] Tarantino later cast Grier as the lead role for *Jackie Brown*. Ellen DeGeneres also read for the part of Jody.^[47] Rosanna's sister Alexis (then known as Robert Arquette) also appears in the film, as a man emerging from a bathroom to shoot at and miss Vincent and Jules, who then kill him.
- Christopher Walken as Captain Koons: A USAF veteran of the Vietnam War who delivers a young Butch his father's prized gold watch. DePauw University professor Kevin Howley called Walken's speech to the young Butch a "bravura performance of patriotic zeal and scatological fetishism worthy of a Kubrickian anti-hero".^[48] During Koons's monologue, which is interspersed with colorful descriptions of the Viet Cong, he mentions a soldier called "Winocki". Joe Winocki (John Garfield) is a character in the 1943 film *Air Force* directed by Howard Hawks, one of Tarantino's favorite directors.^[49] Tarantino played a character named Desmond Winocki in a guest appearance on an episode of *All-American Girl* titled *Pulp Sitcom*.^[50]

Secondary characters

- Bronagh Gallagher plays Jody's friend Trudi, who does little but smoke a bong during the scene where Vincent revives Mia. According to author Jason Bailey, "Quentin thought it would be funny to have this casual observer who just happened to be there. All of this was born out of the experience of, when you go to someone's house to buy drugs, there are always people who are just there".^[51]
- Phil LaMarr portrays Marvin, an associate of Jules and Vincent. LaMarr auditioned for Tarantino after both had done a show for an improv group a few months prior.^[52] He read for the roles of Jules Winnfield and Brett before being cast as Marvin.^[52]

- Tarantino appears as Jules's friend Jimmie, in whose house they clean up a homicide. Tarantino was unsure whether to play Jimmie or Lance, choosing Jimmie as he wanted to be behind the camera during Mia's overdose scene.^[45]
- Frank Whaley portrays Brett, who has a briefcase requested by Marsellus. Whaley met Tarantino while he was filming *Reservoir Dogs* at a lab in Sundance Institute. He recalls, "We ended up meeting and spending time together, and I liked him, so I was really happy when he asked me to be in this movie."^[53]
- Burr Steers appears as Roger, a friend of Brett's nicknamed "Flock of Seagulls" by Jules. The scene of the confrontation between Brett and Jules went through several takes due to Steers making mistakes. Steers recalled in an interview that he had found acting difficult due to the loudness of the gunshots.^[54]
- Angela Jones portrays Esmarelda Villa Lobos, a cab driver who aids Butch's escape. Her casting and character were inspired by her performance in the 1991 short film *Curdled*, later remade as a 1996 feature film with finance from Tarantino and again starring Jones.^[55]
- Duane Whitaker, Peter Greene, and Stephen Hibbert play Maynard, Zed, and the gimp.^[56] According to *The Daily Beast*, these "three psycho hillbillies" that rape Marsellus in Maynard's shop's basement allude to the film *Deliverance*.^{[55][56]}
- Steve Buscemi makes a cameo appearance as a waiter at Jack Rabbit Slim's, dressed as Buddy Holly. Buscemi, who had appeared in *Reservoir Dogs*, was originally considered for the role of Jimmie but was unable to commit.^[55]
- Kathy Griffin appears as herself.^[49]
- Michael Gilden and Joseph Pilato also appear at Jack Rabbit Slim's as waiter Phillip Morris Page and a Dean Martin impersonator, respectively.
- Emil Sitka is seen via archival footage from the *Three Stooges* short *Brideless Groom* (1947)
- Karen Maruyama appears as "Gawker #1" after Butch's car accident,
- Julia Sweeney portrays Raquel, the daughter of the owner of the junkyard in which Marvin's body is disposed of.
- Producer Lawrence Bender makes a cameo as a victim of the diner robbery, credited as "Long Hair Yuppie-Scum".
- Jerome Patrick Hoban appears in the Jack Rabbit Slim's segment as an Ed Sullivan impersonator.
- Susan Griffiths appears alongside Hoban as a Marilyn Monroe impersonator.

Production

Writing

The roots of *Pulp Fiction* can be traced back to the late 1980s, when Quentin Tarantino and Roger Avary worked together at Video Archives, a video store in Southern California.^[57] Avary recalls that their initial concept was to create three short films with three different filmmakers—himself, Tarantino, and a friend, Adam Rifkin.^[57] Avary wrote the first element of what would become the film's screenplay in the fall of 1990,^[58] titled "Pandemonium Reigns", which eventually expanded into a feature-length screenplay.^[57] While Tarantino's short film similarly evolved into a full script, Rifkin never completed his contribution, leaving *Pulp Fiction* initially uncertain.^[57] The initial inspiration was the three-part horror anthology film *Black Sabbath* (1963), by Italian filmmaker Mario Bava.^[59] The Tarantino–Avary project was provisionally titled "Black Mask", after the seminal



Director and co-writer Quentin Tarantino



hardboiled crime fiction magazine.^[39] Tarantino's script was produced as *Reservoir Dogs*, his directorial debut; Avary created the basis for the "Gold Watch" storyline of *Pulp Fiction*.^{[60][61][62][63]}

With work on *Reservoir Dogs* completed, Tarantino returned to the notion of a trilogy film: "I got the idea of doing something that novelists get a chance to do but filmmakers don't: telling three separate stories, having characters float in and out with different weights depending on the story."^[64] Tarantino explains that the idea "was basically to take like the oldest chestnuts that you've ever seen when it comes to crime stories – the oldest stories in the book ... You know, 'Vincent Vega and Marsellus Wallace's Wife' – the oldest story about ... the guy's gotta go out with the big man's wife and don't touch her. You know, you've seen the story a zillion times."^[65] "I'm using old forms of storytelling and then purposely having them run awry", he says.^[66] "Part of the trick is to take these movie characters, these genre characters and these genre situations and actually apply them to some of real life's rules and see how they unravel."^[66] In at least one case, boxer Butch Coolidge, Tarantino had in mind a specific character from a classic Hollywood crime story: "I wanted him to be basically like Ralph Meeker as Mike Hammer in Aldrich's Kiss Me Deadly [1955]. I wanted him to be a bully and a jerk".^[32]

Tarantino went to work on the script for *Pulp Fiction* in Amsterdam in March 1992,^[67] possibly at the Winston Hotel in the Red Light District.^[68] He was joined there by Avary, who contributed "Pandemonium Reigns" to the project and participated in its rewriting as well as the development of the new storylines that would link up with it.^{[60][61][62]} Two scenes originally written by Avary for the *True Romance* screenplay, exclusively credited to Tarantino, were incorporated into the opening of "The Bonnie Situation": the "miraculous" missed shots by the hidden gunman and the rear seat automobile killing.^[69] The notion of the crimeworld "cleaner" that became the heart of the episode was inspired by a short, *Curdled*, that Tarantino saw at a film festival. He cast the lead actress, Angela Jones, in *Pulp Fiction* and later backed the filmmakers' production of a feature-length version of the short, likewise titled *Curdled*.^[70] The script included a couple of made-up commercial brands that often featured in later Tarantino films: Big Kahuna burgers (a Big Kahuna soda cup appears in *Reservoir Dogs*) and Red Apple cigarettes.^[71] As he worked on the script, Tarantino also accompanied *Reservoir Dogs* around the European film festivals. Released in the United States in October 1992, the picture was a critical and commercial success. In January 1993, the *Pulp Fiction* script was complete.^{[72][73]}

The adrenaline scene was inspired by the Martin Scorsese documentary *American Boy: A Profile of Steven Prince* about *Taxi Driver* actor Steven Prince, who played arms dealer Easy Andy in the film.^{[74][75]} Prince recalls injecting adrenaline into the heart of a woman who overdosed, with the help of a medical dictionary and a Magic Marker.^{[74][75]}

Financing

Tarantino and his producer, Lawrence Bender, brought the script to Jersey Films. Before even seeing *Reservoir Dogs*, Jersey had attempted to sign Tarantino for his next project.^[76] Ultimately a development deal worth around \$1 million had been struck: The deal gave A Band Apart, Bender and Tarantino's newly formed production company, initial financing and office facilities; Jersey got a share of the project and the right to shop the script to a studio.^{[77][78][79][80]} Jersey had a distribution and "first look" deal with Columbia TriStar, which paid Tarantino for the right to consider exercising its option.^[31] In February, *Pulp Fiction* appeared on a *Variety* list of films in pre-production at TriStar.^[81] In June, however, the studio put the script into turnaround.^[31] According to a studio executive, TriStar chief Mike Medavoy found it "too demented".^[82] There were suggestions that TriStar was resistant to back a film featuring a heroin user; there were also indications that the studio simply saw the project as too low-budget for its desired star-driven image.^{[83][84]} Avary—who was about to start shooting his own directorial debut, *Killing Zoe*—has said that TriStar's objections were comprehensive, encompassing the script's fundamental structure. He characterizes the studio's position: "'This is the worst thing ever written. It makes no sense. Someone's dead and then they're alive. It's too long, violent, and unfilmable.' ... So I thought, 'That's that!'"^[69]

Bender brought the script to Miramax Films, the formerly independent studio that had recently been acquired by Disney. Harvey Weinstein—co-chairman of Miramax Films, along with his brother Bob—was instantly enthralled by the script and the company picked it up.^[85] Michael Shamberg, the executive producer, reflected on the bidding process, saying, "Only Harvey [Weinstein] bid on it. Harvey thought he was in a bidding war, but he wasn't. To this day, if I see Bob Shaye, he'll tell me that he wished he'd never turned down *Pulp Fiction*. Quentin wanted to do it with Mike Medavoy because Mike had done all the great Orion films, but ironically, when it came along, Mike thought it was too violent."^[57] *Pulp Fiction*, the first Miramax Films project to get a green light after the Disney acquisition, was budgeted at \$8.5 million, and at the end \$500,000 was returned, bringing the final budget to \$8 million.^{[a][57]} According to Bender, a lower budget meant that the producers could maintain more control over the movie itself.^[57] It became the first movie that Miramax Films completely financed.^[86] Helping hold costs down was the plan Bender executed to pay all the main actors the same amount per week, regardless of their industry status.^{[87][31]} *The New York Times* reported, "Most of the actors received relatively small salaries along with a percentage of the profits."^[88] The biggest star to sign on to the project was Bruce Willis. Though he had recently appeared in several big-budget flops, he was still a major overseas draw. On the strength of his name, Miramax Films garnered \$11 million for the film's worldwide rights, virtually ensuring its profitability.^{[89][90]}

Casting

Danny DeVito, one of the film's executive producers,^[91] recalls that Weinstein suggested casting Daniel Day-Lewis, who had just won an Academy Award for *My Left Foot*. DeVito responded by stating that Tarantino wanted John Travolta and reminded Weinstein that he had final cut and cast approval. He later reflected: "I think he [Weinstein] called me every name in the book, but of course, Quentin got what he wanted, and he was absolutely right, and the rest is history."^[57]

Bender noted that during the casting process, while Samuel L. Jackson's initial audition was impressive, another candidate later delivered a performance that "blew them away". This prompted Bender to inform Jackson's agent that they might need to consider the other actor. The agent firmly insisted, "No, no, no, you can't do that. Sam will come back." Initially hesitant to ask him for another audition, Bender discovered that Jackson believed he was simply reading for the role, not auditioning. On his return audition, Jackson said that he was annoyed that he had to come back, and when he arrived an assistant called him "Mr. Fishburne", which made him even more angry. He had also been hungry and had bought a hamburger, which he still had with him. He went on to read his lines, angrily waving the hamburger, which was so real that it became part of the scene and guaranteed him the job.^{[57][40]}

Tim Roth, initially interested in the role meant for Willis, suggested Amanda Plummer as a co-star, insisting she should have a gun as he thought it would be "terrifying" - a notion Tarantino later incorporated into the script.^[57]

Harvey Keitel played a crucial role in getting *Reservoir Dogs* made and introduced Bruce Willis to Tarantino. Bender and Tarantino went to see Willis at his house in Malibu, where they learned that he could recite practically the entire movie of *Reservoir Dogs*, a movie he loved. After a conversation, Tarantino and Willis took a walk on the beach, where Willis revealed he had read the *Pulp Fiction* script and expressed interest in playing Vincent or Jules. Tarantino encouraged him to read the script one last time with the Butch character in mind. Willis called Tarantino the next day and said, "the shortest sentence in the Bible is, 'Jesus wept.' The shortest sentence in Hollywood is, 'I'm in.'"^{[57][92]}

The role of Butch was written with Matt Dillon in mind, however Dillon was hesitant to sign on and preferred the Vincent role, which Tarantino wanted Travolta for.^[92]

Filming

Principal photography commenced on September 20, 1993.^[97] The lead offscreen talent had all worked with Tarantino on *Reservoir Dogs* – cinematographer [Andrzej Sekuła](#), film editor [Sally Menke](#), production designer [David Wasco](#), and costume designer [Betsy Heimann](#). According to Tarantino: "[W]e had \$8 million. I wanted it to look like a \$20–25 million movie. I wanted it to look like an epic. It's an epic in everything – in invention, in ambition, in length, in scope, in everything except the price tag."^[98] The film, he says, was shot "on 50 ASA film stock, which is the slowest stock they make. The reason we use it is that it creates an almost no-grain image, it's lustrous. It's the closest thing we have to 50s Technicolor."^[99] The largest chunk of the budget – \$150,000 – went to creating the Jack Rabbit Slim's set.^{[87][100]} It was built in a [Culver City](#) warehouse, where it was joined by several other sets, as well as the film's production offices.^[101] The diner sequence was shot on location in [Hawthorne](#) at the Hawthorne Grill, known for its [Googie](#) architecture.^[102] For the costumes, Tarantino took his inspiration from French director [Jean-Pierre Melville](#), who believed that the clothes his characters wore were their symbolic suits of armor.^[96] Tarantino cast himself in a modest-sized role as he had in *Reservoir Dogs*. One of his pop totems, [Fruit Brute](#), a long-discontinued [General Mills](#) cereal, also returned from the earlier film.^[103] The shoot wrapped on November 30.^[104] Before *Pulp Fiction*'s premiere, Tarantino convinced [Avary](#) to forfeit his agreed-on cowriting credit and accept a "story by" credit, so the line "Written and directed by Quentin Tarantino" could be used in advertising and onscreen.^[24]



Willis evoked one 1950s actor in particular for Tarantino: "[Aldo Ray](#) in [Jacques Tourneur's](#) *Nightfall* [1956] ... I said let's go for that whole look."^[95] His boxing robe, designed by [Betsy Heimann](#), exemplifies Tarantino's notion of costume as symbolic armor.^[96]

Music

No film score was composed for *Pulp Fiction*; Quentin Tarantino instead used an eclectic assortment of [surf music](#), [rock and roll](#), [soul](#), and [pop songs](#). [Dick Dale](#)'s rendition of "[Misirlou](#)" plays during the opening credits. Tarantino chose surf music as the basic musical style for the film, but not, he insists, because of its association with surfing culture: "To me it just sounds like rock and roll, even [Morricone](#) music. It sounds like rock and roll [spaghetti Western](#) music."^[105] Tarantino planned to use a power pop song, "[My Sharona](#)" by [The Knack](#), during the film's rape scene, but ultimately discounted it.^[56]

Some of the songs were suggested to Tarantino by his friends [Chuck Kelley](#) and [Laura Lovelace](#), who were credited as music consultants. Lovelace also appeared in the film as Laura, a waitress; she reprises the role in *Jackie Brown*.^[106] The [soundtrack album](#) was released along with the film in 1994. The album peaked on the *Billboard* 200 chart at number 21.^[107] The single, [Urge Overkill](#)'s cover of the [Neil Diamond](#) song "[Girl, You'll Be a Woman Soon](#)", reached number 59.^[108]

[Estella Tincknell](#) describes how the particular combination of well-known and obscure recordings helps establish the film as a "self-consciously 'cool' text. [The] use of the mono-tracked, beat-heavy style of early 1960s U.S. 'underground' pop mixed with 'classic' ballads such as [Dusty Springfield](#)'s '[Son of a Preacher Man](#)' is crucial to the film's postmodern knowingness." She contrasts the soundtrack with that of *Forrest Gump*, the highest-grossing film of 1994, which also relies on period pop recordings: "[T]he version of 'the sixties' offered by *Pulp Fiction* ... is certainly not that of the publicly recognized counter-culture featured in *Forrest Gump*, but is, rather, a more genuinely marginal form of sub-culture based around a lifestyle – surfing, 'hanging' – that is resolutely apolitical." The soundtrack is central, she says, to the film's engagement with the "younger, cinematically knowledgeable spectator" it solicits.^[109]

Release and reception

Release and box office

Pulp Fiction premiered in May 1994 at the Cannes Film Festival. The Weinsteins "hit the beach like commandos", bringing the picture's entire cast over to France.^[110] The film was unveiled at a midnight hour screening and caused a sensation.^{[111][112]} It won the Palme d'Or, the festival's top prize, generating a further wave of publicity.^[113]

The first U.S. review of the film was published on May 23 in industry trade magazine *Variety*. Todd McCarthy called *Pulp Fiction* a "spectacularly entertaining piece of pop culture ... a startling, massive success".^[114] From Cannes forward, Tarantino was on the road continuously, promoting the film.^[90] Over the next few months, it played in smaller festivals around Europe, building buzz: Nottingham, Munich, Taormina, Locarno, Norway, and San Sebastián.^[115] Tarantino later said: "One thing that's cool is that by breaking up the linear structure, when I watch the film with an audience, it does break [the audience's] alpha state. It's like, all of a sudden, 'I gotta watch this ... I gotta pay attention.' You can almost feel everybody moving in their seats. It's actually fun to watch an audience in some ways chase after a movie."^[116] In late September, it opened the New York Film Festival. *The New York Times* published its review the day of the opening. Janet Maslin called the film a "triumphant, cleverly disorienting journey through a demimonde that springs entirely from Mr. Tarantino's ripe imagination, a landscape of danger, shock, hilarity and vibrant local color ... [He] has come up with a work of such depth, wit and blazing originality that it places him in the front ranks of American film makers."^[112]

On October 14, 1994, *Pulp Fiction* went into general release in the United States. As Peter Biskind described: "It was not platformed, that is, it did not open in a handful of theaters and roll out slowly as word of mouth built, the traditional way of releasing an indie film; it went wide immediately, into 1,100 theaters."^[117] In the eyes of some cultural critics, *Reservoir Dogs* had given Tarantino a reputation for glamorizing violence. Miramax played with the issue in its marketing campaign: "You won't know the facts till you've seen the fiction", went one slogan.^[118] *Pulp Fiction* was the top-grossing film at the US box office its first weekend with a gross of \$9,311,882, edging out a Sylvester Stallone vehicle, *The Specialist*, which was in its second week and playing at more than twice as many theaters. The gross claimed by Miramax Films was disputed by others. Warner Bros. initially reported an estimated gross of \$8.9 million for *The Specialist*, with Bob Weinstein then reporting a gross for *Pulp Fiction* of \$9.1 million, claiming that the film was on another 100 screens that had previously been overlooked. Warner Bros. then updated their gross to \$9.3 million, claiming they had made a calculation error.^[119] Early Monday morning, Miramax Films reported a gross of \$9.3 million with Warner Bros. reporting \$8.9 million for *The Specialist*, placing *Pulp Fiction* first but other industry sources did not believe Miramax Films' numbers. *Variety* estimated that *Pulp Fiction* grossed \$8.6 to \$9 million for the weekend.^[120]

Against its budget of \$8.5 million and about \$10 million in marketing costs, *Pulp Fiction* grossed \$107.93 million at the U.S. box office, making it the first Miramax film to surpass \$100 million in the United States and Canada.^[121] Worldwide, it took in nearly \$213 million.^[b] In terms of domestic grosses, it was the tenth biggest film of 1994, even though it played on substantially fewer screens than any other film in the top 20.^[123] Popular engagement with the film, such as speculation about the contents of the precious briefcase, "indicates the kind of cult status that *Pulp Fiction* achieved almost immediately".^[124] As *MovieMaker* puts it, "The movie was nothing less than a national cultural phenomenon."^[125] Abroad, as well: in Britain, where it opened a week after its U.S. release, not only was the film a big hit, but in book form its screenplay became the most successful in UK publishing history, a top-ten bestseller.^[126]

External videos

 [Charlie Rose interview with Quentin Tarantino on *Pulp Fiction*, October 14, 1994 \(https://charlierose.com/videos/368\)](https://charlierose.com/videos/368)

Critical response

On the review aggregator website Rotten Tomatoes, 92% of 185 critics' reviews are positive, with an average rating of 9.3/10. The website's consensus reads: "Injecting its compendium of crime tales with the patois of everyday conversation, *Pulp Fiction* is a cinematic shot of adrenaline that cements writer-director Quentin Tarantino as an audacious purveyor of killer kino."^[127] On Metacritic, the film has a weighted average score of 95 out of 100, based on 25 critics, indicating "universal acclaim".^[128] Audiences polled by CinemaScore gave the film an average grade of "B+" on an A+ to F scale.^[129]

The response of major American film reviewers was widely favorable. Roger Ebert called it "a comedy about blood, guts, violence, strange sex, drugs, fixed fights, dead body disposal, leather freaks and a wristwatch that makes a dark journey down through the generations... The screenplay by Tarantino and Roger Avary so well-written in a scruffy, fanzine way that you want to rub noses in it – the noses of those zombie writers who take 'screenwriting' classes that teach them the formulas for 'hit films' ".^[130] Richard Corliss of Time wrote: "It towers over the year's other movies as majestically and menacingly as a gang lord at a preschool. It dares Hollywood films to be this smart about going this far. If good directors accept Tarantino's implicit challenge, the movie theater could again be a great place to live in."^[131] In Newsweek, David Ansen wrote: "The miracle of Quentin Tarantino's *Pulp Fiction* is how, being composed of secondhand, debased parts, it succeeds in gleaming like something new."^[132] "You get intoxicated by it," wrote Entertainment Weekly's Owen Gleiberman, "high on the rediscovery of how pleasurable a movie can be. I'm not sure I've ever encountered a filmmaker who combined discipline and control with sheer wild-ass joy the way that Tarantino does."^[20] "There's a special kick that comes from watching something this thrillingly alive", wrote Peter Travers of Rolling Stone. "*Pulp Fiction* is indisputably great."^[133]

The Los Angeles Times was one of the few major news outlets to publish a negative review on the film's opening weekend. Kenneth Turan wrote: "The writer-director appears to be straining for his effects. Some sequences, especially one involving bondage harnesses and homosexual rape, have the uncomfortable feeling of creative desperation, of someone who's afraid of losing his reputation scrambling for any way to offend sensibilities."^[134] Some who reviewed it in the following weeks took more exception to the predominant critical reaction than to *Pulp Fiction* itself. While not panning the film, Stanley Kauffmann of The New Republic felt that "the way that [it] has been so widely ravaged up and drooled over verges on the disgusting. *Pulp Fiction* nourishes, abets, cultural slumming."^[135] Responding to comparisons between Tarantino's film and the work of French New Wave director Jean-Luc Godard, especially his first, most famous feature, Jonathan Rosenbaum of the Chicago Reader wrote: "The fact that *Pulp Fiction* is garnering more extravagant raves than *Breathless* ever did tells you plenty about which kind of cultural references are regarded as more fruitful – namely, the ones we already have and don't wish to expand."^[136] Observing in the National Review that "[n]o film arrives with more advance hype", John Simon was unswayed: "titillation cures neither hollowness nor shallowness".^[137]

Debate about the film spread beyond the review pages, with its violence often being the theme. In The Washington Post, Donna Britt described how she was happy not to see *Pulp Fiction* on a recent weekend and thus avoid "discussing the rousing scene in which a gunshot sprays somebody's brains around a car interior".^[138] Some commentators took exception to the film's frequent use of the word "nigger" (mentioned 18 times). In the Chicago Tribune, Todd Boyd argued that the word's recurrence "has the ability to signify the ultimate level of hipness for white males who have historically used their perception of black masculinity as the embodiment of cool".^[139] In Britain, James Wood, writing in The Guardian, set the tone for much subsequent criticism: "Tarantino represents the final triumph of postmodernism, which is to empty the artwork of all content, thus avoiding its capacity to do anything except helplessly represent our agonies ... Only in this age could a writer as talented as Tarantino produce artworks so vacuous, so entirely stripped of any politics, metaphysics, or moral interest."^[140]

Awards season

Around the turn of the year, *Pulp Fiction* was named Best Picture by the National Society of Film Critics, National Board of Review, Los Angeles Film Critics Association, Boston Society of Film Critics, Society of Texas Film Critics, Southeastern Film Critics Association, and Kansas City Film Critics Circle.^[c] Tarantino was named Best Director by all seven of those organizations as well as by the New York Film Critics Circle^[147] and Chicago Film Critics Association.^[148] The screenplay won several prizes, with various awarding bodies ascribing credit differently. At the 52nd Golden Globe Awards, Tarantino, named as sole recipient of the Best Screenplay honor, failed to mention Avary in his acceptance speech.^[149] In February 1995, the film received seven Oscar nominations – Best Picture, Director, Actor (Travolta), Supporting Actor (Jackson), Supporting Actress (Thurman), Original Screenplay, and Film Editing. Travolta, Jackson, and Thurman were each nominated as well for the 1st Screen Actors Guild Awards, presented on February 25, but none took home the honor.^[150] At the Academy Awards ceremony the following month, Tarantino and Avary were announced as joint winners of the Academy Award for Best Original Screenplay.^[151] The furor around the film was still going strong: much of the March issue of *Artforum* was devoted to its critical dissection.^[152] *Pulp Fiction* garnered four honors at the Independent Spirit Awards, held at the end of the month – Best Feature, Best Director, Male Lead (Jackson), and Best Screenplay (Tarantino).^[153] At the British Academy Film Awards (BAFTA), Tarantino and Avary shared the BAFTA Award for Best Original Screenplay, and Jackson won for Best Supporting Actor.^[154] The film was nominated for the Grand Prix of the Belgian Film Critics Association.^[155]

The February 2020 issue of *New York Magazine* listed *Pulp Fiction* alongside *Citizen Kane*, *Sunset Boulevard*, *Dr. Strangelove*, *Butch Cassidy and the Sundance Kid*, *The Conversation*, *Nashville*, *Taxi Driver*, *The Elephant Man*, *In the Bedroom*, *There Will Be Blood*, and *Roma* as "*The Best Movies That Lost Best Picture at the Oscars*".^[156]

Legacy and influence

Pulp Fiction quickly came to be regarded as one of the most significant films of its era. In 1995, in a special edition of *Siskel & Ebert* devoted to Tarantino, Gene Siskel argued that the work posed a major challenge to the "ossification of American movies with their brutal formulas". In Siskel's view,

the violent intensity of *Pulp Fiction* calls to mind other violent watershed films that were considered classics in their time and still are. Hitchcock's *Psycho* [1960], Arthur Penn's *Bonnie and Clyde* [1967], and Stanley Kubrick's *A Clockwork Orange* [1971]. Each film shook up a tired, bloated movie industry and used a world of lively lowlifes to reflect how dull other movies had become. And that, I predict, will be the ultimate honor for *Pulp Fiction*. Like all great films, it criticizes other movies.^[157]

Ken Dancyger writes that its "imitative and innovative style" – like that of its predecessor, *Reservoir Dogs* – represents

a new phenomenon, the movie whose style is created from the context of movie life rather than real life. The consequence is twofold – the presumption of deep knowledge on the part of the audience of those forms such as the gangster films or Westerns, horror films or adventure films. And that the parody or alteration of that film creates a new form, a different experience for the audience.^[158]

In a widely covered speech on May 31, 1995, Bob Dole, Senate Majority Leader and Republican presidential candidate for the then-upcoming 1996 presidential election (as well as the party's vice presidential nominee in the 1976 presidential election), attacked the American entertainment industry for peddling "nightmares of depravity". *Pulp Fiction* was soon associated with his charges concerning gratuitous violence. Dole had not mentioned the

film, instead citing two less-celebrated movies based on Tarantino screenplays, Oliver Stone's *Natural Born Killers* and Tony Scott's *True Romance*.^[159] In September 1996, Dole did accuse *Pulp Fiction* – which he had not seen at the time – of promoting "the romance of heroin".^[160]

Paula Rabinowitz expresses the general film industry opinion that *Pulp Fiction* "simultaneously resurrected John Travolta and film noir".^[161] In Peter Biskind's description, it created a "guys-with-guns frenzy".^[162] The film has also been labeled as a black comedy^[3] and a "neo-noir".^{[163][164][165]} Critic Geoffrey O'Brien, however, argued against the classification of *Pulp Fiction* into the neo-noir genre: "The old-time noir passions, the brooding melancholy and operatic death scenes, would be altogether out of place in the crisp and brightly lit wonderland that Tarantino conjures up. [It is] neither neo-noir nor a parody of noir."^[166] Similarly, Nicholas Christopher calls it "more gangland camp than neo-noir",^{[167][168]} and Foster Hirsch suggests that its "trippy fantasy landscape" characterizes it more definitively than any genre label.^[169] Regardless, the stylistic influence of *Pulp Fiction* soon became apparent. Less than a year after the picture's release, British critic Jon Ronson attended the National Film School's end-of-semester screenings and assessed the impact: "Out of the five student movies I watched, four incorporated violent shoot-outs over a soundtrack of iconoclastic 70s pop hits, two climaxed with all the main characters shooting each other at once, and one had two hitmen discussing the idiosyncrasies of *The Brady Bunch* before offing their victim. Not since *Citizen Kane* has one man appeared from relative obscurity to redefine the art of moviemaking."^[170] Among the first Hollywood films cited as its imitators were *Destiny Turns on the Radio* (1995), in which Tarantino acted,^[157] *Things to Do in Denver When You're Dead* (1995),^[171] and *2 Days in the Valley* (1996).^[172] It "triggered a myriad of clones", writes Fiona Villella.^[173] Internationally, according to David Desser, it "not only influenced a British brand of noir, but extended the noir vision virtually around the world".^[174] *Pulp Fiction's* effect on film form was still reverberating in 2007, when David Denby of *The New Yorker* credited it with initiating the ongoing cycle of disordered cinematic narratives.^[175]



John Travolta, Uma Thurman and Quentin Tarantino at the 2014 Cannes Film Festival, for the film's 20th anniversary tribute

According to *Variety*, the trajectory of *Pulp Fiction* from Cannes launch to commercial smash "forever altered the game" of so-called independent cinema.^[176] It "cemented Miramax's place as the reigning indie superpower", writes Biskind.^[117] "*Pulp* became the *Star Wars* of independents, exploding expectations for what an indie film could do at the box office."^[177] The film's large financial return on its small budget

transform[ed] the industry's attitude toward the lowly indies ... spawning a flock of me-too classics divisions ... [S]mart studio executives suddenly woke up to the fact that grosses and market share, which got all the press, were not the same as profits ... Once the studios realized that they could exploit the economies of (small) scale, they more or less gave up buying or remaking the films themselves, and either bought the distributors, as Disney had Miramax, or started their own ... copy[ing] Miramax's marketing and distribution strategies.^[178]

In 2001, *Variety*, noting the increasing number of actors switching back and forth between expensive studio films and low-budget independent or indie-style projects, suggested that the "watershed moment for movie stars" came with the decision by Willis – one of Hollywood's highest-paid performers – to appear in *Pulp Fiction*.^[179] In 2024, on the film's 30th anniversary, the magazine wrote that the film "revived the career of John Travolta, minted a star in Samuel L. Jackson and spawned a still-thriving cottage industry of knockoffs and imitation films".^[57]

It has been described as a "major cultural event", an "international phenomenon" that influenced television, music, literature, and advertising.^{[173][180]} Not long after its release, it was identified as a significant focus of attention within the growing community of Internet users.^[181] Adding *Pulp Fiction* to his roster of *The Great Movies* in 2001, Roger Ebert called it "the most influential film of the decade".^[182] Four years later, *Time*'s Corliss wrote much the same: "(unquestionably) the most influential American movie of the 90s".^[183]

Several scenes and images from the film achieved iconic status; in 2008, *Entertainment Weekly* declared, "You'd be hard-pressed, by now, to name a moment from Quentin Tarantino's film that isn't iconic."^[5] Jules and Vincent's "Royale with Cheese" dialogue became famous.^[184] It was referenced more than a decade and a half later in the Travolta vehicle *From Paris with Love*.^[185] The adrenalin shot to Mia Wallace's heart is on *Premiere*'s list of "100 Greatest Movie Moments".^[186] The scene of Travolta and Thurman's characters dancing has been frequently homaged, most unambiguously in the 2005 film *Be Cool*, starring the same two actors.^[187] The image of Travolta and Jackson's characters standing side by side in suit and tie, pointing their guns, has also become widely familiar. In 2007, *BBC News* reported that "London transport workers have painted over an iconic mural by 'guerrilla artist' Banksy ... The image depicted a scene from Quentin Tarantino's *Pulp Fiction*, with Samuel L. Jackson and John Travolta clutching bananas instead of guns."^[188] Certain lines were adopted popularly as catchphrases, in particular Marsellus's threat, "I'm 'a get medieval on your ass."^[189] Jules's "Ezekiel" recitation was voted the fourth greatest movie speech of all time in a 2004 poll. One of the more notable homages to Jules's "Biblical" quote was one Jackson himself played a part in, near the end of 2014's *Captain America: The Winter Soldier*, Jackson's character Col. Nick Fury, presumed dead, visits his own gravestone, on which, below Fury's name is inscribed "The path of the righteous man ..." Ezekiel 25:17.^[190] In 2019, it was reported that Dominic Cummings, special political adviser to British Prime Minister Boris Johnson, quoted Jules by telling Conservative MPs to "be cool like Fonzie" as political pressure built to request an extension to the date of the UK's withdrawal from the European Union.^[191]

Pulp Fiction now appears in several critical assessments of all-time great films. In 2008, *Entertainment Weekly* named it the best film of the past quarter-century.^[5] That same year, the American Film Institute's "Ten Top Ten" poll ranked it number 7 all-time in the gangster film genre.^[192] In 2007, it was voted 94th overall on the AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Movies list.^[193] In 2005, it was named one of "Time's All-Time 100 Movies".^[183] As of September 2018, it is number 54 on Metacritic's list of all-time highest scores.^[194] The film ranks very highly in popular surveys. A 2008 *Empire* poll combining the opinions of readers, movie industry professionals, and critics named *Pulp Fiction* the ninth-best film of all time.^[195] In a 2006 readers' poll by the British magazine *Total Film*, it ranked as the number three film in history.^[196] It was voted as the fourth-greatest film of all time in a nationwide poll for Britain's Channel 4 in 2001.^[197] In 2015, *Pulp Fiction* ranked 28th on BBC's "100 Greatest American Films" list, voted on by film critics from around the world.^[198]

In April 2026, U S. Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth led a prayer in which he used wording that closely match the famous "Ezekiel 25:17" speech form the movie, by Samuel L. Jackson.^{[199][200]}

Critical analysis

Tarantino has stated that he originally planned "to do a *Black Mask* movie", referring to the magazine largely responsible for popularizing *hardboiled* detective fiction. "[I]t kind of went somewhere else".^[166] Geoffrey O'Brien sees the result as connected "rather powerfully to a parallel pulp tradition: the tales of terror and the uncannily practiced by such writers as Cornell Woolrich [and] Fredric Brown ... Both dealt heavily in the realm of improbable coincidences and cruel cosmic jokes, a realm that *Pulp Fiction* makes its own."^[201] In particular, O'Brien finds a strong affinity between the intricate plot mechanics and twists of Brown's novels and the recursive, interweaving structure of *Pulp Fiction*.^[202] Philip French describes the film's narrative as a "circular movement or Möbius strip of a kind Resnais and Robbe-Grillet would admire".^[203] James Mottram regards crime novelist

Elmore Leonard, whose influence Tarantino has acknowledged, as the film's primary literary antecedent. He suggests that Leonard's "rich dialogue" is reflected in Tarantino's "popular-culture-strewn jive"; he also points to the acute, extremely dark sense of humor Leonard applies to the realm of violence as a source of inspiration.^[204]

Film scholar/historian Robert Kolker sees the "flourishes, the apparent witty banality of the dialogue, the goofy fracturing of temporality [as] a patina over a pastiche. The pastiche ... is essentially of two films that Tarantino can't seem to get out of his mind: *Mean Streets* [1973; directed by Martin Scorsese, who loved *Pulp Fiction* and the way the film was told^[205]] and *The Killing* [1956; directed by Stanley Kubrick]."^[206] He contrasts *Pulp Fiction* with postmodern Hollywood predecessors *Hudson Hawk* (1991; starring Willis) and *Last Action Hero* (1993; starring Arnold Schwarzenegger) that "took the joke too far ... simply mocked or suggested that they were smarter than the audience" and flopped.^[207] Todd McCarthy writes that the film's "striking widescreen compositions often contain objects in extreme close-up as well as vivid contrasts, sometimes bringing to mind the visual strategies of Sergio Leone", an acknowledged hero of Tarantino's.^[114] To Martin Rubin, the "expansive, brightly colored widescreen visuals" evoke comedy directors such as Frank Tashlin and Blake Edwards.^[208]

The movie's host of pop culture allusions, ranging from the famous image of Marilyn Monroe's skirt flying up over a subway grating to Jules addressing a soon-to-be victim as "Flock of Seagulls" because of his haircut,^{[209][210]} have led many critics to discuss it within the framework of postmodernism. Describing the film in 2005 as Tarantino's "postmodern masterpiece ... to date", David Walker writes that it "is marked by its playful reverence for the 1950s ... and its constantly teasing and often deferential references to other films". He characterizes its convoluted narrative technique as "postmodern tricksiness".^[211] Calling the film a "terminally hip postmodern collage", Foster Hirsch finds *Pulp Fiction* far from a masterpiece: "authoritative, influential, and meaningless". Set "in a world that could exist only in the movies", it is "a succulent guilty pleasure, beautifully made junk food for cinéastes".^[212] O'Brien, dismissing attempts to associate the movie with film noir, argues that "*Pulp Fiction* is more a guided tour of an infernal theme park decorated with cultural detritus, Buddy Holly and Mamie Van Doren, fragments of blaxploitation and Roger Corman and *Shogun Assassin*, music out of a twenty-four-hour oldies station for which all the decades since the fifties exist simultaneously."^[166] Catherine Constable takes the moment in which a needle filled with adrenalin is plunged into the comatose Mia's heart as exemplary. She proposes that it "can be seen as effecting her resurrection from the dead, simultaneously recalling and undermining the Gothic convention of the vampire's stake. On this model, the referencing of previous aesthetic forms and styles moves beyond ... empty pastiche, sustaining an 'inventive and affirmative' mode of postmodernism."^[213]

Mark T. Conard asks, "[W]hat is the film *about*?" and answers, "American nihilism".^[214] Hirsch suggests, "If the film is actually about anything other than its own cleverness, it seems dedicated to the dubious thesis that hit men are part of the human family."^[172] Richard Alleva argues that "*Pulp Fiction* has about as much to do with actual criminality or violence as *Cyrano de Bergerac* with the realities of seventeenth-century France or *The Prisoner of Zenda* with Balkan politics." He reads the movie as a form of romance whose allure is centered in the characters' nonnaturalistic discourse, "wise-guy literate, media-smart, obscenely epigrammatic".^[215] In Alan Stone's view, the "absurd dialogue", like that between Vincent and Jules in the scene where the former accidentally kills Marvin, "unexpectedly transforms the meaning of the violence cliché ... *Pulp Fiction* un masks the macho myth by making it laughable and deheroicizes the power trip glorified by standard Hollywood violence."^[216] Stone reads the film as "politically correct. There is no nudity and no violence directed against women ... [It] celebrates interracial friendship and cultural diversity; there are strong women and strong black men, and the director swims against the current of class stereotype."^[216]

Where Stone sees a celebration, Kolker finds a vacuum: "The postmodern insouciance, violence, homophobia, and racism of *Pulp Fiction* were perfectly acceptable because the film didn't pretend seriousness and therefore didn't mock it."^[207] Calling it the "acme of postmodern nineties filmmaking", he explains, "the postmodern is about surfaces; it is flattened spatiality in which event and character are in a steady state of reminding us that they are pop-cultural figures."^[217] According to Kolker:

That's why *Pulp Fiction* was so popular. Not because all audiences got all or any of its references to Scorsese and Kubrick, but because the narrative and spatial structure of the film never threatened to go beyond themselves into signification. The film's cycle of racist and homophobic jokes might threaten to break out into a quite nasty view of the world, but this nastiness keeps being laughed off – by the mock intensity of the action, the prowling, confronting, perverse, confined, and airless nastiness of the world Tarantino creates.^[218]

Henry A. Giroux argues that Tarantino "empties violence of any critical social consequences, offering viewers only the immediacy of shock, humor, and irony-without-insight as elements of mediation. None of these elements gets beyond the seduction of voyeuristic gazing ... [t]he facile consumption of shocking images and hallucinatory delight."^[219]

Regarding the violence and nihilism in the film, Pamela Demory has suggested that *Pulp Fiction* should be seen in light of the short stories of Flannery O'Connor,^[220] which likewise feature "religious elements, banality, and violence with grotesque humor". Discussing "the connection between violence and redemption", Demory concludes that while O'Connor's purpose is to convince readers "of the powerful force of evil in the world and of our need for grace", Tarantino "seeks to demonstrate that in spite of everything we have seen in the film – all the violence, degradation, death, crime, amoral behavior – grace is still possible; there might still be a God who doesn't judge us on merits."^[221]

Homage as essence

Cinema

Pulp Fiction is full of homages to other movies. "Tarantino's characters", writes Gary Groth, "inhabit a world where the entire landscape is composed of Hollywood product. Tarantino is a cinematic kleptomaniac – he literally can't help himself."^[222] Two scenes in particular have prompted discussion of the film's highly intertextual style. Many have assumed that the dance sequence at Jack Rabbit Slim's was intended as a reference to Travolta's star-making performance as Tony Manero in the epochal *Saturday Night Fever* (1977); Tarantino, however, credits a scene in the Jean-Luc Godard film *Bande à part* (1964) with the inspiration. According to the filmmaker, he clarified that the dance scene was not written specifically to showcase John Travolta's dancing; the scene was written in the script before Travolta was cast.^[223] However, once Travolta joined the film, Tarantino embraced the opportunity to feature him dancing, citing Jean-Luc Godard's films as his favorite example of musical sequences, admiring how they appear unpredictably and bring a sense of warmth and spontaneity.^[223] Tarantino noted that the charm lies in the fact that these films are not musical, yet they pause the narrative to include a musical moment, which he found particularly endearing.^[223]

Jerome Charyn argues that, beyond "all the better", Travolta's presence is essential to the power of the scene, and of the film:

Travolta's entire career becomes "backstory", the myth of a movie star who has fallen out of favor, but still resides in our memory as the king of disco. We keep waiting for him to shed his paunch, put on a white polyester suit, and enter the 2001 Odyssey club in Bay Ridge, Brooklyn, where he will dance for us and never, never stop. Daniel Day-Lewis couldn't have woken such a powerful longing in us. He isn't part of America's own mad cosmology ... Tony Manero [is] an angel sitting on Vince's shoulder ... [Vince and Mia's] actual dance may be closer to the choreography of Anna Karina's shuffle with her two bumbling gangster boyfriends in *Bande à part*, but even *that* reference is lost to us, and we're with Tony again ...^[224]

Estella Tincknell notes that while the "diner setting seems to be a simulacrum of a 'fifties' restaurant ... the twist contest is a musical sequence which evokes 'the sixties,' while Travolta's dance performance inevitably references 'the seventies' and his appearance in *Saturday Night Fever*. ...The 'past' thus becomes a more general 'pastness' in which the stylistic signifiers of various decades are loaded in to a single moment."^[225] She also argues that in this passage the film "briefly shifts from its habitually ironic discourse to one that references the conventions of the classic film musical and in doing so makes it possible for the film to inhabit an affective space that goes beyond stylistic allusion."^[225]

The pivotal moment in which Marsellus crosses the street in front of Butch's car and notices him evokes the scene in which Marion Crane's boss sees her under similar circumstances in *Psycho* (1960).^{[226][227]} Marsellus and Butch are soon held captive by Maynard and Zed, "two sadistic honkies straight out of *Deliverance*" (1972), directed by John Boorman.^[216] Zed shares a name with Sean Connery's character in Boorman's follow-up, the science-fiction film *Zardoz* (1974). When Butch decides to rescue Marsellus, in Glyn White's words, "he finds a trove of items with film-hero resonances".^[228] Critics have identified these weapons with a range of possible allusions:

- Hammer – *The Toolbox Murders* (1978)^[229]
- Baseball bat – *Walking Tall* (1973);^[228] *The Untouchables* (1987)^[229]
- Chainsaw – *The Texas Chain Saw Massacre* (1974);^{[228][229]} *Evil Dead II* (1987)^[228]
- Katana (samurai sword) – many, including *Seven Samurai* (1954);^{[228][229]} *The Yakuza* (1975);^[228] and *Shogun Assassin* (1980)^[229]

At the conclusion of the scene, a portentous line of Marsellus's echoes one from the crime drama *Charley Varrick* (1973), directed by another of Tarantino's heroes, Don Siegel; the name of the character who speaks it there is Maynard.^{[230][231][232][233]}

David Bell argues that far from going against the "current of class stereotype", this scene, like *Deliverance*, "mobilize[s] a certain construction of poor white country folk – and particularly their sexualization ... 'rustic sexual expression often takes the form of homosexual rape' in American movies".^[234] Stephen Paul Miller believes the *Pulp Fiction* scene goes down much easier than the one it echoes: "The buggery perpetrated is not at all as shocking as it was in *Deliverance* ... The nineties film reduces seventies competition, horror, and taboo into an entertainingly subtle adrenaline play – a fiction, a pulp fiction."^[235] Giroux reads the rape scene homage similarly: "in the end Tarantino's use of parody is about repetition, transgression, and softening the face of violence by reducing it to the property of film history."^[236] In Groth's view, the crucial difference is that "in *Deliverance* the rape created the film's central moral dilemma whereas in *Pulp Fiction* it was merely 'the single weirdest day of [Butch's] life.'"^[237] ("*American Me* did it too," Tarantino observed. "There's like *three* butt-fucking scenes in *American Me*. That's definitely the one to beat in that particular category!"^[238])

Neil Fulwood focuses on Butch's weapon selection, writing, "Here, Tarantino's love of movies is at its most open and nonjudgemental, tipping a nod to the noble and the notorious, as well as sending up his own reputation as an enfant terrible of movie violence. Moreover, the scene makes a sly comment about the readiness of cinema to seize upon whatever is to hand for its moments of mayhem and murder."^[229] White asserts that "the katana he finally, and significantly, selects identifies him with ... honourable heroes."^[228] Conard argues that the first three items symbolize a nihilism that Butch is rejecting. The traditional Japanese sword, in contrasts, represents a culture with a well-defined moral code and thus connects Butch with a more meaningful approach to life.^[239]

The biker film *Nam's Angels* is also shown with Fabienne characterizing it as "A motorcycle movie, I'm not sure the name."^[240]

Television

Robert Miklitsch argues that "Tarantino's telephilia" may be more central to the guiding sensibility of *Pulp Fiction* than the filmmaker's love for rock 'n' roll and even cinema:

Talking about his generation, one that came of age in the '70s, Tarantino has commented that the "number one thing we all shared wasn't music, that was a Sixties thing. Our culture was television." A random list of the TV programs referenced in *Pulp Fiction* confirms his observation: *Speed Racer*, *Clutch Cargo*, *The Brady Bunch*, *The Partridge Family*, *The Avengers*, *The Three Stooges*, *The Flintstones*, *I Spy*, *Green Acres*, *Kung Fu*, *Happy Days*, and last but not least, Mia's fictional pilot, *Fox Force Five*.^[241]

"The above list, with the possible exception of *The Avengers*," writes Miklitsch, "suggests that *Pulp Fiction* has less of an elective affinity with the cinematic avant-gardism of Godard than with mainstream network programming."^[242] Jonathan Rosenbaum had brought TV into his analysis of the Tarantino/Godard comparison, acknowledging that the directors were similar in wanting to cram everything they like onscreen: "But the differences between what Godard likes and what Tarantino likes and why are astronomical; it's like comparing a combined museum, library, film archive, record shop, and department store with a jukebox, a video-rental outlet, and an issue of *TV Guide*."^[136]

Sharon Willis focuses on the way a television show (*Clutch Cargo*) marks the beginning of, and plays on through, the scene between young Butch and his father's comrade-in-arms. The Vietnam War veteran is played by Christopher Walken, whose presence in the role evokes his performance as a traumatized G.I. in the Vietnam War movie *The Deer Hunter* (1978). Willis writes that "when Captain Koons enters the living room, we see Walken in his function as an image retrieved from a repertoire of 1970s television and movie versions of ruined masculinity in search of rehabilitation ... [T]he gray light of the television presiding over the scene seems to inscribe the ghostly paternal gaze."^[243] Miklitsch asserts that, for some critics, the film is a "prime example of the pernicious ooze-like influence of mass culture exemplified by their *bête noire*: TV."^[242] Kolker might not disagree, arguing that "*Pulp Fiction* is a simulacrum of our daily exposure to television; its homophobes, thugs and perverts, sentimental boxers and pimp promoters move through a series of long-take tableaux: we watch, laugh, and remain with nothing to comprehend."^[218]

Notable motifs

The mysterious 666 briefcase

The combination of the mysterious suitcase lock is 666, the "Number of the Beast". Tarantino has said there is no explanation for its contents – it is simply a *MacGuffin*, a pure plot device. Originally, the case was to contain diamonds, but this was seen as too mundane. For filming purposes, it contained a hidden orange light bulb that produced an otherworldly glow when the case was opened.^[246] In a 2007 video interview with fellow director and friend Robert Rodriguez, Tarantino purportedly "reveals" the secret contents of the briefcase, but the film cuts out and skips the scene in the style employed in Tarantino and Rodriguez's *Grindhouse* (2007), with an intertitle that reads "Missing Reel". The interview resumes with Rodriguez discussing how radically the "knowledge" of the briefcase's contents alters one's understanding of the movie.^[247]

Despite Tarantino's statements, many solutions to what one scholar calls this "unexplained postmodern puzzle" have been proposed.^[124] A strong similarity has often been observed with Robert Aldrich's 1955 film noir *Kiss Me Deadly*, which features a glowing briefcase housing an atomic explosive.^{[237][248][249]} In their review of Alex Cox's 1984 film *Repo Man* in *The Daily Telegraph*, Nick Cowen and Hari Patience suggest that *Pulp Fiction* may also owe "a debt of inspiration" to the glowing car trunk in that film.^[250] In scholar Paul Gormley's view, this connection with *Kiss Me Deadly*, and a similar one with *Raiders of the*



Vincent "stares ... transfixed" into the glowing case, as specified in Tarantino's screenplay.^[244]



Vincent's demeanor reinforces the allusion to the scene in *Kiss Me Deadly* (1955) in which Lily Carver, a.k.a. Gabrielle (Gaby Rodgers), gazes into the glowing case.^[245]

Lost Ark (1981), makes it possible to read the eerie glow as symbolic of violence itself.^[251] The idea that the briefcase contains Marsellus's soul gained popular currency in the mid-1990s. Analyzing the notion, Roger Ebert dismissed it as "nothing more than a widely distributed urban legend given false credibility by the mystique of the Net".^[252]

Jules' Bible passage

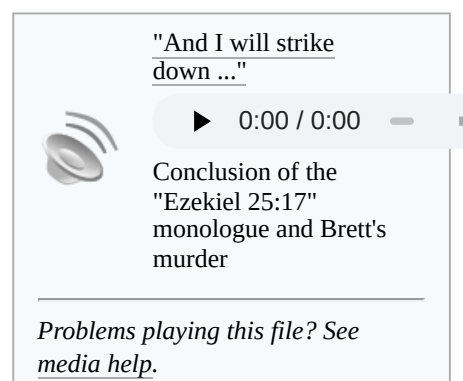
Jules ritually recites what he describes as a biblical passage, Ezekiel 25:17, before he executes someone. The passage is heard three times – in the introductory sequence in which Jules and Vincent reclaim Marsellus's briefcase from the doomed Brett; that same recitation a second time, at the beginning of "The Bonnie Situation", which overlaps the end of the earlier sequence; and in the epilogue at the diner. The first version of the passage is as follows:

The path of the righteous man is beset on all sides by the inequities of the selfish and the tyranny of evil men. Blessed is he who in the name of charity and goodwill shepherds the weak through the valley of darkness, for he is truly his brother's keeper and the finder of lost children. And I will strike down upon thee with great vengeance and furious anger those who attempt to poison and destroy My brothers. And you will know My name is the Lord when I lay My vengeance upon thee.

The second version, from the diner scene, is identical except for the final line: "And you will know I am the Lord when I lay My vengeance upon you."

While the final two sentences of Jules's speech are similar to the actual cited passage, the first two are fabricated from various biblical phrases.^[253] The text of Ezekiel 25 preceding verse 17 indicates that God's wrath is retribution for the hostility of the Philistines. In the King James Version from which Jules's speech is adapted, Ezekiel 25:17 reads in its entirety:

And I will execute great vengeance upon them with furious rebukes; and they shall know that I *am* the LORD, when I shall lay My vengeance upon them.^[254]



Tarantino's primary inspiration for the speech was the work of Japanese martial arts star Sonny Chiba. Its text and its identification as Ezekiel 25:17 derive from an almost identical creed that appears at the beginning of the Chiba movie *Karate Kiba* (*The Bodyguard*; 1976), where it is both shown as a scrolling text and read by an offscreen narrator.^{[255][256]}

The version seen at the beginning of *The Bodyguard* (1976) is as follows:

The path of the righteous man and defender is beset on all sides by the inequity of the selfish and the tyranny of evil men. Blessed is he, who in the name of charity and good will, shepherds the weak through the valley of darkness, for he is truly his brother's keeper, and the father of lost children. And I will execute great vengeance upon them with furious anger, who poison and destroy my brothers; and they shall know that I am Chiba the Bodyguard when I shall lay my vengeance upon them!

In the 1980s television series *Kage no Gundan* (*Shadow Warriors*), Chiba's character would lecture the villain-of-the-week about how the world must be rid of evil before killing him.^[257] A killer delivers a similar biblical rant in *Modesty Blaise*, the hardback but pulp-style novel Vincent is shown with in two scenes.^[258]

Two critics who have analyzed the role of the speech find different ties between Jules's transformation and the issue of postmodernity. Gormley argues that unlike the film's other major characters – Marsellus aside – Jules is:

linked to a "thing" beyond postmodern simulation ... [T]his is perhaps most marked when he moves on from being a simulation of a Baptist preacher, spouting Ezekiel because it was "just a cool thing to say ..." In his conversion, Jules is shown to be cognizant of a place beyond this simulation, which, in this case, the film constructs as God.^[259]

Adele Reinhartz writes that the "depth of Jules's transformation" is indicated by the difference in his two deliveries of the passage: "In the first, he is a majestic and awe-inspiring figure, proclaiming the prophecy with fury and self-righteousness ... In the second ... he appears to be a different sort of man altogether ... [I]n true postmodern fashion, [he] reflects on the meaning of his speech and provides several different ways that it might pertain to his current situation."^[260] Similar to Gormley, Conard argues that as Jules reflects on the passage, it dawns on him "that it refers to an objective framework of value and meaning that is absent from his life"; to Conard, this contrasts with the film's prevalent representation of a nihilistic culture.^[261] Rosenbaum finds much less in Jules's revelation: "[T]he spiritual awakening at the end of *Pulp Fiction*, which Jackson performs beautifully, is a piece of jive avowedly inspired by kung-fu movies. It may make you feel good, but it certainly doesn't leave you any wiser."^[136]

The bathroom

Much of *Pulp Fiction*'s action revolves around characters who are either in the bathroom or need to use the toilet. To a lesser extent, Tarantino's other films also feature this narrative element.^[262] At Jack Rabbit Slim's, Mia goes to "powder her nose" – literally; she snorts cocaine in the restroom. Butch and Fabienne play an extended scene in their motel bathroom, he in the shower, she brushing her teeth; the next morning, but just a few seconds later in screen time, she is again brushing her teeth – vigorously, after having given Butch "oral pleasure". As Jules and Vincent confront Brett and two of his pals, a fourth man is hiding in the bathroom – his actions will lead to Jules' transformative "moment of clarity". After Marvin's absurd death, Vincent and Jules wash up in Jimmie's bathroom, where they argue over a bloody hand towel.^[175] When the diner holdup turns into a standoff, "Honey Bunny" whines, "I gotta go pee!"^[263]

As described by Peter and Will Brooker, "In three significant moments Vincent retires to the bathroom [and] returns to an utterly changed world where death is threatened."^[264] The threat increases in magnitude as the narrative progresses chronologically, and is realized in the third instance:

1. Vincent and Jules's diner breakfast and philosophical conversation is aborted by Vincent's bathroom break; an armed robbery ensues while Vincent is reading on the toilet.
2. While Vincent is in the bathroom worrying about the possibility of going too far with Marsellus's wife, Mia mistakes his heroin for cocaine, snorts it, and overdoses.
3. During a stakeout at Butch's apartment, Vincent emerges from the toilet with his book and is killed by Butch.

In the Brookers' analysis, "Through Vince ... we see the contemporary world as utterly contingent, transformed, disastrously, in the instant you are not looking."^[264] Fraiman finds it particularly significant that Vincent is reading *Modesty Blaise* in two of these instances. She links this fact with the traditional derisive view of women as "the archetypal consumers of pulp":

Locating popular fiction in the bathroom, Tarantino reinforces its association with shit, already suggested by the dictionary meanings of "pulp" that preface the movie: moist, shapeless matter; also, lurid stories on cheap paper. What we have then is a series of damaging associations – pulp, women, shit – that taint not only male producers of mass-market fiction but also male consumers. Perched on the toilet with his book, Vincent is feminized by sitting instead of standing as well as by his trashy tastes; preoccupied by

the anal, he is implicitly infantilized and homosexualized; and the seemingly inevitable result is being pulverized by Butch with a Czech M61 submachine gun. That this fate has to do with Vincent's reading habits is strongly suggested by a slow tilt from the book on the floor directly up to the corpse spilled into the tub.^[265]

Willis reads *Pulp Fiction* in almost precisely the opposite direction, finding "its overarching project as a drive to turn shit into gold. This is one way of describing the project of redeeming and recycling popular culture, especially the popular culture of one's childhood, as is Tarantino's wont as well as his stated aim."^[243] Despite that, argues Fraiman, "*Pulp Fiction* demonstrates ... that even an open pulpophile like Tarantino may continue to feel anxious and emasculated by his preferences."^[263]

Accolades

Pulp Fiction won eight major awards from a total of twenty-six nominations, including a Best Original Screenplay win at the 67th Academy Awards.^{[113][151][154][266][141]} Also, in the balloting by the National Society of Film Critics, Samuel L. Jackson was the runner-up in both the Best Actor and the Best Supporting Actor categories.^[141] In 2006, Writers Guild of America ranked its screenplay 16th in WGA's list of 101 Greatest Screenplays.^[4]

American Film Institute Lists

- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Movies – No. 95^[267]
- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Laughs – Nominated^[268]
- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Thrills – No. 53^[269]
- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Heroes & Villains:^[270]
 - Vincent Vega and Jules Winnfield – Nominated Villains
- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Movie Quotes:^[271]
 - "Bring out the Gimp" – Nominated Quote
 - "They call it a Royale with Cheese" – Nominated Quote
- AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Movies (10th Anniversary Edition) – No. 94^[193]
- AFI's 10 Top 10 – No. 7 gangster film^[192]

Home media and ownership

The first home video release was a VHS on September 12, 1995.^[272] Following their June 1993 sale to The Walt Disney Company, all of Miramax's home video releases were handled by Disney's Buena Vista Home Entertainment. However, the releases were being branded as Miramax Home Entertainment releases rather than Disney/Buena Vista releases, as a result of the studio's adult focused content. In 1996, Miramax issued a Special Collector's Edition VHS, which included deleted scenes introduced by Tarantino.^[273] In Australia, the Special Collector's Edition VHS was released in late 1997, through Village Roadshow, who had an Australian distribution agreement with Miramax at the time.^[274] The film's first US LaserDisc release occurred on October 4, 1995, and was followed by a special Criterion Collection LaserDisc release on June 19, 1996.^[275] Between 1995 and 1997, the film received additional LaserDisc releases in France, Germany, Hong Kong, Japan, Spain, Taiwan, and the United Kingdom.^[275] On August 20, 2002, Miramax Home Entertainment released a two-disc Collector's Edition DVD. This version included DTS sound, and extensive extras such as documentaries, interviews with cast and crew, and trailers.^{[276][277]}

In December 2010, The Walt Disney Company sold Miramax to a private equity holding company known as Filmyard Holdings. The company had multiple investors, including Tutor-Saliba Corporation and the private equity firm Colony Capital, who were making their first entertainment-related investment.^{[278][279]} Filmyard licensed the home media rights for most of Miramax's notable titles to Lionsgate Films, with lower profile titles being licensed to Echo Bridge Entertainment.^[280] Lionsgate Home Entertainment reissued *Pulp Fiction* on DVD on April 26, 2011, and on October 1, 2011, the film received a Blu-ray release through Lionsgate Home Entertainment.^{[281][282]} The UK version of the Lionsgate Blu-ray was released on November 26, 2012.^[283] In 2011, Filmyard Holdings licensed the Miramax library to streamer Netflix. This streaming deal included *Pulp Fiction*, and ran for five years, eventually ending on June 1, 2016.^[284]

Filmyard Holdings sold Miramax to Qatari state-owned company beIN Media Group in March 2016.^[285] In April 2020, ViacomCBS (now known as Paramount Skydance) acquired the rights to Miramax's library, after buying a 49% stake in the studio from beIN.^[286] *Pulp Fiction* is among the 700 titles they acquired in the deal,^{[287][288][289]} and since April 2020, the film has been distributed by Paramount Pictures. The deal also included a first look agreement with beIN/Miramax, which allows Paramount to release any future projects based on Miramax properties.^[290]

In late 2020, Paramount Home Entertainment started reissuing many of the Miramax titles they had acquired, and on September 22, 2020, they reissued *Pulp Fiction* on DVD and Blu-ray.^{[281][291]} Most of Paramount's Miramax reissues during this period had the same artwork as previous releases, but add the Paramount mountain logo to the packaging. On December 6, 2022, Paramount Home Entertainment released *Pulp Fiction* on 4K Ultra HD Blu-ray.^[281] The release includes special features originally from the 2011 Lionsgate Blu-ray.^[292] In celebration of *Pulp Fiction*'s 30th anniversary, Paramount Home Entertainment released a 4K Ultra HD Collector's Edition on December 3, 2024, as an Amazon-exclusive set (also available via Zavvi in Australia). This edition retains the 2022 version's 2160p transfer with HDR-10 and Dolby Vision, also retaining the legacy special features. It includes a new slipcover featuring pop-up artwork of the Jack Rabbit Slim's dance scene between John Travolta and Uma Thurman. Additional collectibles include reproductions of lobby cards showcasing key film moments, a photography contact sheet, and collectible stickers/decals with film imagery, all presented in a protective folder with custom artwork.^[293]

Pulp Fiction was not one of the inaugural titles included on Paramount's subscription streaming service Paramount+, which launched on March 4, 2021, although it was later added to the service.^{[294][295]} It has also been made available on Paramount's free streaming service Pluto TV.^[296]

NFT dispute

In November 2021, Miramax filed a lawsuit against Tarantino who released seven NFTs based on uncut and unseen scenes of *Pulp Fiction* and including the original handwritten script "revealing secrets about the film and its creator". Miramax claimed they own the film rights.^[297] Tarantino disputed the lawsuit and claimed he had rights to the film script in written form.^[298] The matter was later settled with Miramax's lawyers filing a brief statement in court: "The parties have agreed to put this matter behind them and look forward to collaborating with each other on future projects, including possible NFTs."^[299]

See also



Film portal



United States portal



- [The Killers \(Hemingway short story\)](#)
- [The Killers \(1946\)](#)
- [List of cult films](#)
- [Plump Fiction](#)
- [Pulp Friction](#)
- [Quentin Tarantino filmography](#)

Notes

- a. In Waxman (2005, p. 67), Biskind (2004, p. 170), Polan (2000, p. 69), Dawson (1995a, pp. 147–148)
- b. ^{[117][122][2]} *Box Office Mojo* gives \$106 million in foreign grosses for a worldwide total of \$213.9 million; Biskind and Waxman apparently concur that \$105M / \$212.9M are the correct figures.
- c. National Society of Film Critics,^[141] National Board of Review,^[142] Los Angeles Film Critics Society,^[143] Boston Society of Film Critics,^[144] Society of Texas Film Critics,^[145] Kansas City Film Critics Circle^[146]

References

1. "Pulp Fiction" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150510235257/http://www.bbfc.co.uk/releases/pulp-fiction-on-film-0>). *British Board of Film Classification*. Archived from the original (<https://www.bbfc.co.uk/BFF065215>) on May 10, 2015. Retrieved November 11, 2012.
2. "Pulp Fiction (1994)" (<https://boxofficemojo.com/movies/?id=pulpfiction.htm>). *Box Office Mojo*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110430222745/http://www.boxofficemojo.com/movies/?id=pulpfiction.htm>) from the original on April 30, 2011. Retrieved May 13, 2012.
3. See, e.g., King (2002), pp. 185–7; Kempley, Rita (October 14, 1994). "Pulp Fiction (R)" (https://www.washingtonpost.com/wp-srv/style/longterm/movies/videos/pulpfictionrkempley_a01ac7.htm). *The Washington Post*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20170709034854/http://www.washingtonpost.com/wp-srv/style/longterm/movies/videos/pulpfictionrkempley_a01ac7.htm) from the original on July 9, 2017. Retrieved September 19, 2007.; LaSalle, Mike (September 15, 1995). "Pulp Grabs You Like a Novel" (<https://www.sfgate.com/movies/article/FILM-REVIEW-Pulp-Grabs-You-Like-a-Novel-3024865.php>). *San Francisco Chronicle*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120112023743/http://www.sfgate.com/cgi-bin/article.cgi?f=%2Fc%2Fa%2F1995%2F09%2F15%2FDD26653.DTL>) from the original on January 12, 2012. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
4. "101 Greatest Screenplays" (https://web.archive.org/web/20130306065813/http://www.wga.org/subpage_newsevents.aspx?id=1807). Writers Guild of America, West. Archived from the original (http://www.wga.org/subpage_newsevents.aspx?id=1807) on March 6, 2013. Retrieved November 29, 2015.
5. "The New Classics: Movies" (<https://ew.com/article/2007/06/18/new-classics-movies/>). *Entertainment Weekly*. June 18, 2007. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20080828181342/http://www.ew.com/ew/gallery/0,,20207076_20207079_20207442_24,00.html) from the original on August 28, 2008. Retrieved September 29, 2013.
6. O'Sullivan, Michael (December 18, 2013). "Library of Congress announces 2013 National Film Registry selections" (https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/movies/library-of-congress-announces-2013-national-film-registry-selections/2013/12/17/eba98bce-6737-11e3-ae56-22de072140a2_story.html). *The Washington Post*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20131218140500/http://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/movies/library-of-congress-announces-2013-national-film-registry-selections/2013/12/17/eba98bce-6737-11e3-ae56-22de072140a2_story.html) from the original on December 18, 2013. Retrieved December 18, 2013.

7. "Complete National Film Registry Listing" (<https://www.loc.gov/programs/national-film-preservation-board/film-registry/complete-national-film-registry-listing/>). *Library of Congress*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20161031213743/https://www.loc.gov/programs/national-film-preservation-board/film-registry/complete-national-film-registry-listing/>) from the original on October 31, 2016. Retrieved May 8, 2020.
8. "Cinema with the Right Stuff Marks 2013 National Film Registry" (<https://www.loc.gov/item/prn-13-216/2013-national-film-registry/2013-12-18/>). *Library of Congress*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200604221938/https://www.loc.gov/item/prn-13-216/2013-national-film-registry/2013-12-18/>) from the original on June 4, 2020. Retrieved May 8, 2020.
9. Parker 2002, p. 23.
10. Dancyger 2002, p. 235.
11. Villella, Fiona A. (January 2000). "Circular Narratives: Highlights of Popular Cinema in the '90s" (<http://web.archive.org/web/20061231115331/http://www.sensesofcinema.com/contents/00/3/circular.html#b2>). *Senses of Cinema*. Archived from the original (<http://archive.sensesofcinema.com/contents/00/3/circular.html#b2>) on December 31, 2006. Retrieved December 31, 2006.
12. Bhattacharya, Sanjiv (April 18, 2004). "Mr Blonde's Ambition" (<https://www.theguardian.com/film/2004/apr/18/features.magazine>). *The Guardian*. London. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080709093114/http://film.guardian.co.uk/interview/interviewpages/0,6737,1194170,00.html>) from the original on July 9, 2008. Retrieved December 27, 2006.
13. Charyn 2006, p. 68.
14. For \$100,000, see e.g., Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 3, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment). For USD\$140,000, see e.g., Wills, Dominic. "John Travolta Biography" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070104050530/http://www.tiscali.co.uk/entertainment/film/biographies/john_travolta_biog/4). Tiscali. Archived from the original (http://www.tiscali.co.uk/entertainment/film/biographies/john_travolta_biog/4) on January 4, 2007. Retrieved December 27, 2006. Note again that all the main actors were paid identical weekly salaries. It appears that these figures cited for Travolta do not include his participation, if any, in the film's profits.
15. Haddon, Cole (August 7, 2008). "Michael Madsen Talks Hell Ride, Inglorious Bastards, and Sin City 2" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20081023235552/http://www.film.com/movies/story/michael-madsen-talks-hell-ride/22258175>). *Film.com*. Archived from the original (<http://www.film.com/movies/story/michael-madsen-talks-hell-ride/22258175>) on October 23, 2008. Retrieved November 18, 2008.
16. Dawson 1995, p. 154.
17. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 5, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
18. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 3, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
19. "Samuel L. Jackson's 'Pulp Fiction' Jheri Curl Wig Was a Happy Accident" (<https://www.yahoo.com/entertainment/samuel-l-jacksons-pulp-fiction-jheri-curl-wig-000105962.html>). *Yahoo*. January 6, 2016. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220217105859/https://www.yahoo.com/entertainment/samuel-l-jacksons-pulp-fiction-jheri-curl-wig-000105962.html>) from the original on February 17, 2022. Retrieved February 17, 2022.
20. Gleiberman, Owen (October 10, 1994). "*Pulp Fiction* (1994)" (<https://ew.com/article/1994/10/14/movie-review-pulp-fiction/>). *Entertainment Weekly*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071015004935/http://www.ew.com/ew/article/0,,304048,00.html>) from the original on October 15, 2007. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
21. "Laurence Fishburne Turned Down Samuel L. Jackson's Role in 'Pulp Fiction' " (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200820185534/https://www.theringer.com/video/2020/1/16/21068675/laurence-fishburne-turned-down-samuel-l-jackson-role-in-pulp-fiction>). *The Ringer*. Archived from the original (<https://www.theringer.com/video/2020/1/16/21068675/laurence-fishburne-turned-down-samuel-l-jackson-role-in-pulp-fiction>) on August 20, 2020. Retrieved August 21, 2020.
22. Jung, E. Alex (August 19, 2020). "Laurence Fishburne Knows Who He Is" (<https://www.vulture.com/article/laurence-fishburne-in-conversation.html>). *Vulture*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200821082213/https://www.vulture.com/article/laurence-fishburne-in-conversation.html>) from the original on August 21, 2020. Retrieved August 21, 2020.
23. "Quentin Tarantino's original Pulp Fiction cast choices revealed in resurfaced note" (<https://www.independent.co.uk/arts-entertainment/films/news/quentin-tarantino-pulp-fiction-cast-b1970469.html>). *Independent.co.uk*. December 6, 2021.
24. Biskind 2004, p. 170.

25. Dawson 1995a, p. 155.
26. Wills, Dominic. "Uma Thurman Biography" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070507080424/http://www.w.tiscali.co.uk/entertainment/film/biographies/uma_thurman_biog/6). Tiscali. Archived from the original (http://www.tiscali.co.uk/entertainment/film/biographies/uma_thurman_biog/6) on May 7, 2007. Retrieved December 29, 2006.
27. Goldberg, Reid (October 26, 2024). "You Won't Believe Who Quentin Tarantino Had in Mind for 'Pulp Fiction'" (<https://collider.com/quentin-tarantino-pulp-fiction-cast/>). *Collider*. Retrieved January 14, 2025.
28. "Pulp Fiction 20th Anniversary Casting Choice" (<https://people.com/movies/pulp-fiction-20th-anniversary-casting-choice/>).
29. Bart 2000, p. 85.
30. Polan 2000, p. 69: Willis's deal for a percentage of the box office gross was presumably on top of a base weekly salary that was identical to the other main actors, per Polan.
31. Dawson 1995a, p. 148.
32. Dargis 1994a, p. 10.
33. Tarantino, Quentin; Peary, Gerald (2013). *Quentin Tarantino: Interviews, Revised and Updated* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=RRmcAQAAQBAJ&q=%22aldo+ray%22+interview&pg=PA50>). University Press of Mississippi. pp. 50–51. ISBN 9781617038747. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211023050607/https://books.google.com/books?id=RRmcAQAAQBAJ&q=%22aldo+ray%22+interview&pg=PA50>) from the original on October 23, 2021. Retrieved March 4, 2022 – via Google Books.
34. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 23, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
35. McCarthy, Todd (March 19, 1993). "Point of No Return" (<https://variety.com/1993/film/reviews/point-of-no-return-2-1200431702/>). *Variety*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240604203857/https://variety.com/1993/film/reviews/point-of-no-return-2-1200431702/>) from the original on June 4, 2024. Retrieved June 4, 2024.
36. Charyn 2006, p. 73.
37. Bailey 2013, p. 84.
38. Dawson, Jeff (December 1995). "Hit Man" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130120090146/http://www.tim-roth.com/index.php?id=ukpremieredec95>). *Premiere (UK)*. Tim-Roth.com. Archived from the original (<http://www.tim-roth.com/index.php?id=ukpremieredec95>) on January 20, 2013. Retrieved April 11, 2012.
39. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 14, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
40. Seal, Mark (February 13, 2013). "Cinema Tarantino: The Making of *Pulp Fiction*" (<https://www.vanityfair.com/hollywood/2013/03/making-of-pulp-fiction-oral-history/amp>). *Vanity Fair*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190115053439/https://www.vanityfair.com/hollywood/2013/03/making-of-pulp-fiction-oral-history/amp>) from the original on January 15, 2019. Retrieved July 9, 2020.
41. "Sid Haig Interview! Episode: 40" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20081120065456/http://www.a3upodcast.com/node/187>). Archived from the original on November 20, 2008. Retrieved July 20, 2008.
42. Brennan, Sandra. "Ving Rhames Biography" (<https://www.allmovie.com/artist/ving-rhames-p59836>). *AllMovie*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120413180958/http://www.allmovie.com/artist/ving-rhames-p59836>) from the original on April 13, 2012. Retrieved April 11, 2012.
43. "Cobain Turned Down 'Pulp Fiction' Role" (http://www.hollywood.com/news/Cobain_Turned_Down_Pulp_Fiction_Role/3555873). *Hollywood.com*. September 20, 2006. Retrieved September 16, 2007.
44. Roberts, Chris (August 1999). "Gary Oldman: A sheep in wolf's clothing". *Uncut* (27). IPC Media. "[*True Romance*] wouldn't have been [Oldman's] last Tarantino collaboration, had TriStar execs gotten their way ... Oldman was the preferred choice for [Lance]."
45. "50 Things You (Probably) Didn't Know About Pulp Fiction" ([https://web.archive.org/web/20131105123711/http://www.shortlist.com/entertainment/films/50-things-you-\(probably\)-didnt-know-about-pulp-fiction](https://web.archive.org/web/20131105123711/http://www.shortlist.com/entertainment/films/50-things-you-(probably)-didnt-know-about-pulp-fiction)). *ShortList*. October 28, 2013. Archived from the original ([http://www.shortlist.com/entertainment/films/50-things-you-\(probably\)-didnt-know-about-pulp-fiction](http://www.shortlist.com/entertainment/films/50-things-you-(probably)-didnt-know-about-pulp-fiction)) on November 5, 2013. Retrieved August 26, 2014.

46. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 6, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment). See also Rabin, Nathan (June 25, 2003). "Interviews: Pam Grier" (<https://www.avclub.com/pam-grier-1798208273>). *The A.V. Club*. The Onion. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071002130523/http://www.avclub.com/content/node/22535>) from the original on October 2, 2007. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
47. Dawson 1995a, p. 189.
48. Howley, K. (2004). "Breaking, Making, and Killing Time in Pulp Fiction". *Scope: An Online Journal of Film and Television Studies*: 10.
49. France, Lisa (October 14, 2014). "'Pulp Fiction': 20 fun facts as the film turns 20" (<http://www.cnn.com/2014/09/23/showbiz/movies/pulp-fiction-20th-anniversary/index.html>). *CNN*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180729150353/http://www.cnn.com/2014/09/23/showbiz/movies/pulp-fiction-20th-anniversary/index.html>) from the original on July 29, 2018. Retrieved August 14, 2018.
50. "Quentin Tarantino on All-American Girl (February 22, 1995)" (<http://www.chronologicalsnobbery.com/2007/11/quentin-tarantino-on-all-american-girl.html>). *Chronological Snobbery*. November 26, 2007. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160312154706/http://www.chronologicalsnobbery.com/2007/11/quentin-tarantino-on-all-american-girl.html>) from the original on March 12, 2016. Retrieved March 11, 2016.
51. Getlen, Larry (October 18, 2014). "Inside the grisly scene that made 'Pulp Fiction' " (<https://nypost.com/2014/10/18/inside-the-grisly-scene-that-made-pulp-fiction/>). *New York Post*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171114030842/http://nypost.com/2014/10/18/inside-the-grisly-scene-that-made-pulp-fiction/>) from the original on November 14, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
52. Harris, Will (June 26, 2012). "Phil LaMarr on Futurama and getting shot in the face for Pulp Fiction" (<https://www.avclub.com/article/phil-lamarr-on-ifuturamai-and-getting-shot-in-the--81774>). *The A.V. Club*. The Onion. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170316113201/http://www.avclub.com/article/phil-lamarr-on-ifuturamai-and-getting-shot-in-the--81774>) from the original on March 16, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
53. Harris, Will (April 9, 2015). "Frank Whaley on acting, directing, and getting yelled at by Samuel L. Jackson and Oliver Stone" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170103174249/https://www.avclub.com/article/frank-whaley-acting-directing-and-getting-yelled-s-215751>). *The A.V. Club*. Archived from the original (<https://www.avclub.com/article/frank-whaley-acting-directing-and-getting-yelled-s-215751>) on January 3, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
54. Eisenberg, Eric (January 27, 2016). "The Pulp Fiction Scene That Burr Steers Kept Screwing Up, And Why" (<https://www.cinemablend.com/new/Pulp-Fiction-Scene-Burr-Steers-Kept-Screwing-Up-Why-108537.html>). *Cinema Blend*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170426201242/http://www.cinemablend.com/new/Pulp-Fiction-Scene-Burr-Steers-Kept-Screwing-Up-Why-108537.html>) from the original on April 26, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
55. "The Secrets of 'Pulp Fiction': 20 Things You Didn't Know About the Movie on Its 20th Anniversary" (<http://www.thedailybeast.com/articles/2014/10/19/the-secrets-of-pulp-fiction-20-things-you-didn-t-know-about-the-movie-on-its-20th-anniversary.html>). *The Daily Beast*. October 19, 2014. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170315174845/http://www.thedailybeast.com/articles/2014/10/19/the-secrets-of-pulp-fiction-20-things-you-didn-t-know-about-the-movie-on-its-20th-anniversary.html>) from the original on March 15, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
56. Edwards, Gavin (May 21, 2014). "'Get the Gimp': Breaking Down 'Pulp Fiction's Most Notorious Scene" (<https://www.rollingstone.com/movies/news/get-the-gimp-breaking-down-pulp-fictions-most-notorious-scene-20140521>). *Rolling Stone*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170917193424/http://www.rollingstone.com/movies/news/get-the-gimp-breaking-down-pulp-fictions-most-notorious-scene-20140521>) from the original on September 17, 2017. Retrieved March 15, 2017.
57. Gilchrist, Todd (October 14, 2024). "'Pulp Fiction' Turns 30: How Quentin Tarantino's Masterpiece Saved Careers, Conquered Film Festivals and Changed Cinema Forever" (<https://variety.com/2024/film/news/pulp-fiction-quentin-tarantino-30th-anniversary-retrospective-part-one-1236175164/>). *Variety*. Retrieved October 21, 2024.
58. Biskind 2004, p. 129.
59. Bailey 2013, p. 32.
60. Biskind 2004, p. 167.
61. Dawson 1995a, pp. 144–146.
62. MacInnis, Craig (October 8, 1994). "Heavyweight Tarantino Won't Be Taken Lightly". *Toronto Star*.

63. Bauer, Erik (August 10, 2013). "Method Writing: Interview with Quentin Tarantino - Originally published in January 1998" (<https://www.creativescreenwriting.com/method-writing-interview-with-quentin-tarantino/>). *Creative Screenwriting* (Interview). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210909053014/https://www.creativescreenwriting.com/method-writing-interview-with-quentin-tarantino/>) from the original on September 9, 2021. Retrieved March 19, 2022.
64. Lowry, Beverly (September 11, 1994). "Criminals Rendered in 3 Parts, Poetically" (<https://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/11/movies/the-new-season-film-criminals-rendered-in-3-parts-poetically.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230521051045/https://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/11/movies/the-new-season-film-criminals-rendered-in-3-parts-poetically.html>) from the original on May 21, 2023. Retrieved May 20, 2023.
65. "Pulp Fiction: The Facts" (1993 location interview), *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
66. "Pulp Fiction: The Facts" (1994 promotional interview), *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
67. Dawson 1995a, p. 139.
68. Steves, Rick (April 14, 2015). *Rick Steves Amsterdam & the Netherlands* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=DBOCBgAAQBAJ&q=pulp%2520fiction%2520%2522the%2520winston%2522%2520tarantino%2520amsterdam&pg=PT168>). Avalon Travel. ISBN 978-1-63121-067-9. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20201113181753/https://books.google.com/books?id=DBOCBgAAQBAJ&q=pulp%2520fiction%2520%2522the%2520winston%2522%2520tarantino%2520amsterdam&pg=PT168>) from the original on November 13, 2020. Retrieved October 18, 2020.
69. Mottram 2006, p. 71.
70. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 13, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
71. Wells, Jeffrey (July 12, 1996). "Searching for a Big Kahuna Burger" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20091008125832/http://archive.southcoasttoday.com/daily/07-96/07-12-96/c04ae104.htm>). *SouthCoast Today*. Archived from the original (<http://archive.southcoasttoday.com/daily/07-96/07-12-96/c04ae104.htm>) on October 8, 2009. Retrieved September 19, 2007.
72. Charyn 2006, p. 65.
73. Dawson 1995a, p. 147: The published version of the screenplay identifies its basis as "May 1993/last draft", incorporating brief revisions made in August, September, and October (Tarantino [1994], n.p.).
74. Dry, Jude (January 26, 2017). "How the 'Pulp Fiction' Adrenaline Shot Scene Was Inspired by Scorsese's 'Lost Film' — Watch" (<https://www.indiewire.com/features/general/pulp-fiction-overdose-scene-scorsese-tarantino-watch-1201773966/>). *IndieWire*.
75. Beyl, Cameron (January 6, 2023). "Ultimate Guide To Martin Scorsese And His Directing Techniques" (<https://indiefilmhustle.com/ultimate-guide-to-martin-scorsese-and-his-directing-techniques/>). Indie Film Hustle. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250217152025/https://indiefilmhustle.com/ultimate-guide-to-martin-scorsese-and-his-directing-techniques/>) from the original on February 17, 2025. Retrieved February 24, 2025.
76. Dawson 1995a, p. 140.
77. Dawson 1995a, p. 146.
78. Biskind 2004, p. 167: Biskind says \$1 million.
79. Polan 2000, p. 68: Polan says "close to a million dollars".
80. Enhanced Trivia Track, *Pulp Fiction* DVD, says \$900,000 (ch. 14)
81. "TriStar Pictures Slate for 1993" (<https://variety.com/1993/film/news/tristar-pictures-slate-for-1993-103729/>). *Variety*. February 5, 1993. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080630001906/http://www.variety.com/article/VR103729.html?categoryid=13&cs=1&query=%22pulp+fiction%22+1994+tarantino>) from the original on June 30, 2008. Retrieved September 21, 2007.
82. Biskind 2004, p. 168.
83. Polan 2000, pp. 68–69.
84. Biskind 2004, pp. 167–168.
85. Biskind 2004, p. 168–169.
86. Dawson 1995a, p. 149.
87. Polan 2000, p. 69.

88. Weinraub, Bernard (September 22, 1994). "A Film Maker and the Art of the Deal" (<https://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/22/movies/a-film-maker-and-the-art-of-the-deal.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170709114430/http://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/22/movies/a-film-maker-and-the-art-of-the-deal.html>) from the original on July 9, 2017. Retrieved October 8, 2007.
89. Biskind 2004, p. 170: Tarantino claims the overseas sales were due to his own name.
90. Dawson 1995a, p. 173.
91. Kuperinsky, Amy (October 14, 2024). "Danny DeVito: 'Pulp Fiction' producer Harvey Weinstein reamed me out for casting N.J. legend" (<https://www.nj.com/entertainment/2024/10/danny-devito-pulp-fiction-producer-harvey-weinstein-reamed-me-out-for-casting-nj-legend.html>). *nj*. Retrieved October 21, 2024.
92. Coll, Thomas (June 7, 2023). "Matt Dillon turned down Quentin Tarantino and 'Pulp Fiction' " (<https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/matt-dillon-turned-down-quentin-tarantino-pulp-fiction/>). *Faroutmagazine.co.uk*. Retrieved June 9, 2026.
93. Brooker & Brooker (1996, p. 234)
94. Polan (2000, p. 23)
95. Quoted in Dargis (1994a, p. 10). Other sources have claimed that Butch was patterned after Ray's *Nightfall* role.^[93] Tarantino's one public statement on the topic, quoted in Polan,^[94] is clearly devoted to Butch's look and not his personality.
96. Dargis 1994b, p. 17.
97. Polan 2000, pp. 69, 70.
98. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 8, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
99. Dargis 1994b, p. 18.
100. Dawson 1995a, p. 159.
101. Dawson 1995a, pp. 159–160.
102. Dawson 1995a, p. 158: The Hawthorne Grill was torn down not long after the *Pulp Fiction* shoot.
103. Hoffman 2005, p. 46.
104. Dawson 1995a, p. 164.
105. Dawson 1995a, p. 162.
106. Enhanced Trivia Track, chs. 1, 2, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
107. "*Pulp Fiction*: Charts & Awards/*Billboard* Albums" (<https://www.allmusic.com/album/r204558>). AllMusic.com. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110422181600/http://www.allmusic.com/album/r204558>) from the original on April 22, 2011. Retrieved December 26, 2006.
108. "*Pulp Fiction*: Charts & Awards/*Billboard* Singles" (<https://www.allmusic.com/album/r204558>). AllMusic.com. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110422181600/http://www.allmusic.com/album/r204558>) from the original on April 22, 2011. Retrieved September 14, 2007.
109. Tincknell 2006, p. 139.
110. Charyn 2006, p. 96.
111. Biskind 2004, p. 174.
112. Maslin, Janet (September 23, 1994). "Pulp Fiction; Quentin Tarantino's Wild Ride On Life's Dangerous Road" (<https://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/23/movies/film-festival-review-pulp-fiction-quentin-tarantino-s-wild-ride-life-s-dangerous.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180515224056/https://www.nytimes.com/1994/09/23/movies/film-festival-review-pulp-fiction-quentin-tarantino-s-wild-ride-life-s-dangerous.html>) from the original on May 15, 2018. Retrieved September 11, 2007.
113. "All the Awards—Festival 1994" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071013220900/http://www.festival-cannes.com/index.php/en/archives/awards/1994>). Cannes Festival. Archived from the original (<http://www.festival-cannes.com/index.php/en/archives/awards/1994>) on October 13, 2007. Retrieved September 14, 2007.
114. McCarthy, Todd (May 23, 1994). "*Pulp Fiction*" (<https://variety.com/1994/film/reviews/pulp-fiction-1200437049/>). *Variety*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171228172344/https://variety.com/1994/film/reviews/pulp-fiction-1200437049/>) from the original on December 28, 2017. Retrieved September 20, 2007.

115. "Pulp Fiction" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071012013656/http://variety.com/profiles/Film/main/30051/Pulp%2BFiction.html?dataSet=1&query=%22pulp%2Bfiction%22%2B1994>). *Variety*. Archived from the original (<https://www.variety.com/profiles/Film/main/30051/Pulp+Fiction.html?dataSet=1&query=%22pulp+fiction%22+1994>) on October 12, 2007. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
116. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 24, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
117. Biskind 2004, p. 189.
118. Dawson 1995a, p. 171.
119. Klady, Leonard (October 17, 1994). "Shootout at the B.O. peak". *Daily Variety*. p. 1.
120. Klady, Leonard (October 18, 1994). "'Pulp' claims B.O. title; competitors call it fiction". *Daily Variety*. p. 1.
121. "Miramax in hit land". *Screen International*. August 22, 1997. p. 33.
122. Waxman 2005, p. 78.
123. "1994 Domestic Grosses" (<https://www.boxofficemojo.com/yearly/chart/?yr=1994&p=.htm>). *Box Office Mojo*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110717164659/http://www.boxofficemojo.com/yearly/chart/?yr=1994&p=.htm>) from the original on July 17, 2011. Retrieved September 12, 2007.
124. Real 1996, p. 259.
125. Rose, Andy (Winter 2004). "10 Years of MovieMaker, 10 Years of Indie Film Growth" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071122005136/http://www.moviemaker.com/articles/item/10_years_of_moviemaker_10_years_of_indie_film_2952/). *MovieMaker*. Archived from the original (http://www.moviemaker.com/articles/item/10_years_of_moviemaker_10_years_of_indie_film_2952/) on November 22, 2007. Retrieved September 21, 2007.
126. Dawson 1995a, pp. 171, 13.
127. "Pulp Fiction" (https://www.rottentomatoes.com/m/pulp_fiction). *Rotten Tomatoes*. Fandango Media. Retrieved January 16, 2026.
128. "Pulp Fiction Reviews" (<https://www.metacritic.com/movie/pulp-fiction>). *Metacritic*. CBS Interactive. Retrieved December 29, 2006.
129. "Find CinemaScore" (<https://www.cinemascore.com>) (Type "Pulp Fiction" in the search box). *CinemaScore*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180102130540/https://www.cinemascore.com/>) from the original on January 2, 2018. Retrieved March 20, 2019.
130. Ebert, Roger (October 14, 1994). "Pulp Fiction" (<https://www.rogerebert.com/reviews/pulp-fiction-1994>). *RogerEbert.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130216033721/http://rogerebert.suntimes.com/apps/pbcs.dll/article?AID=%2F19941014%2FREVIEWS%2F410140304%2F1023>) from the original on February 16, 2013. Retrieved September 12, 2007.
131. Corliss, Richard (October 10, 1994). "A Blast to the Heart" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20090402010106/http://www.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,981560-1,00.html>). *TIME*. Archived from the original (<http://www.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,981560-1,00.html>) on April 2, 2009. Retrieved September 11, 2007.
132. Ansen, David (October 9, 1994). "The Redemption of Pulp" (<https://www.newsweek.com/redemption-pulp-189436>). *Newsweek*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230521051042/https://www.newsweek.com/redemption-pulp-189436>) from the original on May 21, 2023. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
133. Travers, Peter (October 14, 1994). "Pulp Fiction" (<https://www.rollingstone.com/movies/reviews/pulp-fiction-19941014>). *Rolling Stone*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110415121356/http://www.rollingstone.com/movies/reviews/pulp-fiction-19941014>) from the original on April 15, 2011. Retrieved March 10, 2011.
134. Turan, Kenneth (October 14, 1994). "Quentin Tarantino's Gangster Rap" (<https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1994-10-14-ca-50020-story.html>). *Los Angeles Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180505050442/http://articles.latimes.com/1994-10-14/entertainment/ca-50020_1_pulp-fiction) from the original on May 5, 2018. Retrieved April 10, 2018.
135. Kauffman, Stanley (November 14, 1994). "Shooting Up" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180411025845/https://newrepublic.com/article/61392/shooting>). *The New Republic*. Archived from the original (<https://newrepublic.com/article/61392/shooting>) on April 11, 2018. Retrieved April 10, 2018.

136. Rosenbaum, Jonathan (October 21, 1994). "Allusion Profusion (*Ed Wood*, *Pulp Fiction*)" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230521051042/https://jonathanrosenbaum.net/2022/06/allusion-profusion/>). *Chicago Reader*. Archived from the original (<https://jonathanrosenbaum.net/2022/06/allusion-profusion/>) on May 21, 2023. Retrieved May 20, 2023. Note that the avowed inspiration is actually a TV show, *Kung Fu*.
137. Simon, John (November 21, 1994). "Pulp Fiction" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071130072735/http://findarticles.com/p/articles/mi_m1282/is_n22_v46/ai_15999907/pg_1). *National Review*. Vol. 46, no. 22. Archived from the original on November 30, 2007. Retrieved October 8, 2010.
138. Britt, Donna (October 25, 1994). "Let's Lose the Gory 'Gulp' Fiction" (<https://www.washingtonpost.com/archive/local/1994/10/25/lets-lose-the-gory-gulp-fiction/db0b009-b042-46ad-b245-cc5ad0f4be01/>). *The Washington Post*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180615032351/https://www.washingtonpost.com/archive/local/1994/10/25/lets-lose-the-gory-gulp-fiction/db0b009-b042-46ad-b245-cc5ad0f4be01/>) from the original on June 15, 2018. Retrieved April 10, 2018.
139. Boyd, Todd (November 6, 1994). "Tarantino's Mantra?" (<https://www.chicagotribune.com/1994/11/06/tarantinos-mantra/>). *Chicago Tribune*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180411025837/http://articles.chicagotribune.com/1994-11-06/entertainment/9411060361_1_n-word-hipness-true-romance) from the original on April 11, 2018. Retrieved April 10, 2018.
140. Wood, James (November 12, 1994). *The Guardian*.
141. Maslin, Janet (January 4, 1995). "'Pulp Fiction' Gets Top Prize From National Film Critics" (<https://www.nytimes.com/1995/01/04/movies/pulp-fiction-gets-top-prize-from-national-film-critics.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170709114845/http://www.nytimes.com/1995/01/04/movies/pulp-fiction-gets-top-prize-from-national-film-critics.html>) from the original on July 9, 2017. Retrieved September 27, 2007.
142. "1994 Award Winners" (<https://nationalboardofreview.org/award-years/1994/>). *National Board of Review*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211003002208/https://nationalboardofreview.org/award-years/1994/>) from the original on October 3, 2021. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
143. "'Pulp Fiction,' Tarantino Win L.A. Film Critics Awards" (<https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1994-12-11-mn-7795-story.html>). *Los Angeles Times*. December 11, 1994. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200831213218/https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1994-12-11-mn-7795-story.html>) from the original on August 31, 2020. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
144. "Boston Society of Film Critics Awards 1994" (<https://bostonfilmcritics.org/past-winners-1990s/>). *bostonfilmcritics.org*. July 27, 2018. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190717194814/https://bostonfilmcritics.org/past-winners-1990s/>) from the original on July 17, 2019. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
145. "Texas film critics group doles out awards for the year's best in movies" (https://web.archive.org/web/20121024041911/http://nl.newsbank.com/nl-search/we/Archives?p_product=AASB&p_theme=aasb&p_action=search&p_maxdocs=200&p_topdoc=1&p_text_direct-0=0EAD96057255BCDF&p_field_direct-0=document_id&p_perpage=10&p_sort=YMD_date:D&s_trackval=GooglePM). *The Austin American-Statesman*. December 18, 1994. Archived from the original (http://nl.newsbank.com/nl-search/we/Archives?p_product=AASB&p_theme=aasb&p_action=search&p_maxdocs=200&p_topdoc=1&p_text_direct-0=0EAD96057255BCDF&p_field_direct-0=document_id&p_perpage=10&p_sort=YMD_date:D&s_trackval=GooglePM) on October 24, 2012. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
146. "1994 Awards" (<https://kcfcc.org/kcfcc-award-winners-1990-99/>). *kcfcc.org*. December 14, 2013. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210307071345/https://kcfcc.org/kcfcc-award-winners-1990-99/>) from the original on March 7, 2021. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
147. "Critics Honor 'Pulp Fiction' And 'Quiz Show' " (<https://www.nytimes.com/1994/12/16/movies/critics-honor-pulp-fiction-and-quiz-show.html>). *The New York Times*. December 16, 1994. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20201122205138/https://www.nytimes.com/1994/12/16/movies/critics-honor-pulp-fiction-and-quiz-show.html>) from the original on November 22, 2020. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
148. "The 7th Annual Chicago Film Critics Awards" (<https://chicagofilmcritics.org/awards-blog/archives>). *chicagofilmcritics.org*. January 2013. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210410183233/https://chicagofilmcritics.org/awards-blog/archives>) from the original on April 10, 2021. Retrieved May 24, 2023.
149. Biskind 2004, p. 206.
150. "1st Annual SAG Awards Nominees" (https://web.archive.org/web/20081015185836/http://www.sagawards.org/1_award_nom). *SAG Awards*. Archived from the original (http://www.sagawards.org/1_award_nom) on October 15, 2008. Retrieved August 15, 2009.

151. "Academy Awards for Pulp Fiction" (https://web.archive.org/web/20131029194626/http://awardsdata.base.oscars.org/ampas_awards/DisplayMain.jsp). AMPAS. Archived from the original (http://awardsdata.base.oscars.org/ampas_awards/DisplayMain.jsp;jsessionid=F5E20EAF29DB9C3219EAAC6FE3B868C9.jicama?curTime=1167423497977) on October 29, 2013. Retrieved December 29, 2006.
152. Charyn 2006, p. 87.
153. Natale, Richard (March 27, 1995). "'Pulp Fiction' Wings It at Independent Spirit Awards" (<https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1995-03-27-ca-47721-story.html>). *Los Angeles Times*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20110430111123/http://articles.latimes.com/1995-03-27/entertainment/ca-47721_1_independent-spirit-awards) from the original on April 30, 2011. Retrieved August 15, 2009.
154. "Film Winners 1990–1999" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070202074453/http://www.bafta.org/site/webdav/site/myjahiasite/shared/import/Film_Winners_1990-1999.pdf) (PDF). BAFTA. Archived from the original (http://www.bafta.org/site/webdav/site/myjahiasite/shared/import/Film_Winners_1990-1999.pdf) (PDF) on February 2, 2007. Retrieved December 29, 2006.
155. "'Exotica' à l'UCC" (https://web.archive.org/web/20130120104851/http://archives.lesoir.be/loulou-gaste_t-19950109-Z08Z7R.html). *Le Soir* (in French). January 9, 1995. p. 9. Archived from the original (http://archives.lesoir.be/loulou-gaste_t-19950109-Z08Z7R.html) on January 20, 2013. Retrieved October 27, 2012.
156. "The Best Movies That Lost Best Picture at the Oscars" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200306121315/https://www.vulture.com/article/best-oscar-best-picture-losers.html>). *Vulture*. New York. February 10, 2020. Archived from the original (<https://www.vulture.com/article/best-oscar-best-picture-losers.html>) on March 6, 2020. Retrieved February 24, 2020.
157. "Pulp Faction: The Tarantino Generation", *Siskel & Ebert, Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
158. Dancyger 2002, p. 228.
159. Janofsky, Michael (June 4, 1995). "Reviews by Weekend Moviegoers Are In. Dole Gets a Thumbs Down" (<https://www.nytimes.com/1995/06/04/us/reviews-by-weekend-moviegoers-are-in-dole-gets-a-thumbs-down.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180602064611/https://www.nytimes.com/1995/06/04/us/reviews-by-weekend-moviegoers-are-in-dole-gets-a-thumbs-down.html>) from the original on June 2, 2018. Retrieved October 8, 2007. Lacayo, Richard (June 12, 1995). "Violent Reaction" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080422075503/http://www.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,983035-1,00.html>). *Time*. Archived from the original (<http://www.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,983035-1,00.html>) on April 22, 2008. Retrieved October 8, 2007.
160. Gorman, Steven J. (August 19, 1996). "Dole Takes on Drug Issue: Clinton Faulted for 'Naked' Lack of Leadership" (<http://www.thefreelibrary.com/DOLE+TAKES+ON+DRUG+ISSUE+:+CLINTON+FAULTED+FOR+%60NAKED'+LACK+OF...-a083968058>). *Daily News*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080719202147/http://www.thefreelibrary.com/DOLE+TAKES+ON+DRUG+ISSUE+%3A+CLINTON+FAULTED+FOR+%60NAKED'%27+LACK+OF...-a083968058>) from the original on July 19, 2008. Retrieved October 8, 2007.
161. Rabinowitz 2002, p. 15.
162. Biskind 2004, p. 258.
163. Waxman 2005, p. 64.
164. Silver & Ursini 2004, p. 65.
165. Real 1996, p. 122.
166. O'Brien 1994, p. 90.
167. Christopher 2006, p. 240.
168. Rubin 1999, pp. 174–175.
169. Hirsch 1997, p. 359.
170. Dawson 1995a, p. 207.
171. Rosenbaum, Jonathan (June 16, 1995). "The World According to Harvey and Bob (*Smoke, The Glass Shield*)" (<https://jonathanrosenbaum.net/2023/03/the-world-according-to-harvey-and-bob/>). *Chicago Reader*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230521051037/https://jonathanrosenbaum.net/2023/03/the-world-according-to-harvey-and-bob/>) from the original on May 21, 2023. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
172. Hirsch 1997, p. 360.

173. Villella, Fiona A. (January 2000). "Circular Narratives: Highlights of Popular Cinema in the '90s" (<http://web.archive.org/web/20061126215319/http://www.sensesofcinema.com/contents/00/3/circular.html#b2>). *Senses of Cinema*. Archived from the original (<http://archive.sensesofcinema.com/contents/00/3/circular.html#b2>) on November 26, 2006. Retrieved December 31, 2006.
174. Desser 2003, p. 519.
175. Denby, David (March 5, 2007). "The New Disorder" (https://www.newyorker.com/arts/critics/atlarge/2007/03/05/070305crat_atlarge_denby). *The New Yorker*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20090404093026/http://www.newyorker.com/arts/critics/atlarge/2007/03/05/070305crat_atlarge_denby) from the original on April 4, 2009. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
176. Elley, Derek (May 14, 2006). "Who Launched Whom?" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20090402142636/http://www.variety.com/index.asp?layout=features2006&content=jump&jump=story&dept=cannes&nav=FCannes&articleid=VR1117942945>). *Variety*. Archived from the original (<https://www.variety.com/index.asp?layout=features2006&content=jump&jump=story&dept=cannes&nav=FCannes&articleid=VR1117942945>) on April 2, 2009. Retrieved September 18, 2007.
177. Biskind 2004, p. 195.
178. Biskind 2004, p. 193.
179. Koehler, Robert (March 7, 2001). "For Art's Sake" (<https://variety.com/2001/film/awards/for-art-s-sake-2-1117794890/>). *Variety*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20081012072032/http://www.variety.com/article/VR1117794890.html?categoryid=1037&cs=1&query=%22pulp+fiction%22+1994+tarantino>) from the original on October 12, 2008. Retrieved September 21, 2007.
180. Samuels, Mark (November 8, 2006). "*Pulp Fiction*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071009170856/http://www.totalfilm.com/features/specials/pulp_fiction). *Total Film*. Archived from the original (http://www.totalfilm.com/features/specials/pulp_fiction) on October 9, 2007. Retrieved September 21, 2007. For musical influence, see, e.g., Sarig, Roni (1996). "Fun Lovin' Criminals—*Come Find Yourself*" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080621204015/http://www.rollingstone.com/artists/funlovincriminals/albums/album/107552/review/5944992/come_find_yourself). *Rolling Stone*. Archived from the original (https://web.archive.org/web/20080621204015/http://www.rollingstone.com/artists/funlovincriminals/albums/album/107552/review/5944992/come_find_yourself) on June 21, 2008. Retrieved October 8, 2007.
181. Butler, Robert W. (March 17, 1996). "*Pulp Fiction* Is a Cultural Phenomenon—And That's a Fact". *The Kansas City Star*.
182. Ebert, Roger (June 10, 2001). "Great Movies: *Pulp Fiction* (1994)" (<https://www.rogerebert.com/reviews/great-movie-pulp-fiction-1994>). *Chicago Sun-Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130213235156/http://rogerebert.suntimes.com/apps/pbcs.dll/article?AID=%2F20010610%2FREVIEWS08%2F106100301%2F1023>) from the original on February 13, 2013. Retrieved December 29, 2006.
183. "All-Time 100 Movies: *Pulp Fiction* (1994)" (https://web.archive.org/web/20070603155000/http://www.time.com/time/2005/100movies/0,23220,pulp_fiction,00.html). *Time*. February 12, 2005. Archived from the original (http://www.time.com/time/2005/100movies/0,23220,pulp_fiction,00.html) on June 3, 2007. Retrieved May 15, 2007.
184. See, e.g., Wilson, Bee (February 14, 2007). "The Joy and Horror of Junk Food" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071121220459/http://tls.timesonline.co.uk/article/0,,25348-2597639,00.html>). *Times Literary Supplement*. London. Archived from the original (<http://tls.timesonline.co.uk/article/0,,25348-2597639,00.html>) on November 21, 2007. Retrieved October 11, 2007. Gates, Anita (August 1, 2004). "Movies: Critic's Choice" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2004/08/01/tv/movies-critic-s-choice.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180602064545/https://www.nytimes.com/2004/08/01/tv/movies-critic-s-choice.html>) from the original on June 2, 2018. Retrieved October 11, 2007.
185. Rea, Steven (February 5, 2010). "Travolta, Rhys Meyers Pummel Paris" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160314104706/http://articles.philly.com/2010-02-05/entertainment/24955905_1_charlie-wax-secret-agent-man-pierre-morel). *The Philadelphia Inquirer*. Archived from the original (http://articles.philly.com/2010-02-05/entertainment/24955905_1_charlie-wax-secret-agent-man-pierre-morel) on March 14, 2016. Retrieved February 9, 2010.
186. Waxman 2005, p. 72: Waxman misidentifies the list, which appeared in *Premiere*'s March 2003 issue, as "100 Most Memorable Movie Scenes".
187. Laverick, Daniel. "Selling a Movie in Two Minutes—The Modern Day Film Trailer" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071011212644/http://www.close-upfilm.com/features/Featuresarchive/sellingamovie.html>). *Close-Up Film*. Archived from the original (<http://www.close-upfilm.com/features/Featuresarchive/sellingamovie.html>) on October 11, 2007. Retrieved September 11, 2007.

188. "Iconic Banksy Image Painted Over" (http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/uk_news/6575345.stm). *BBC News*. April 20, 2007. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20100106021340/http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/uk_news/6575345.stm) from the original on January 6, 2010. Retrieved September 11, 2007.
189. Dinshaw 1997, p. 116.
190. "'Napalm' Speech Tops Movie Poll" (<http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/entertainment/3362603.stm>). *BBC News*. January 2, 2004. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20090708135503/http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/entertainment/3362603.stm>) from the original on July 8, 2009. Retrieved September 19, 2007.
191. Duncan, Conrad (September 8, 2019). "Dominic Cummings: Boris Johnson's adviser 'quoted Pulp Fiction' by telling aides they need to be 'cool like Fonzie'" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190909064808/https://www.indy100.com/article/dominic-cummings-pulp-fiction-cool-like-fonzies-boris-johnson-brexit-9095526>). *The Independent*. Archived from the original (<https://www.indy100.com/article/dominic-cummings-pulp-fiction-cool-like-fonzies-boris-johnson-brexit-9095526>) on September 9, 2019. Retrieved September 9, 2019.
192. "AFI's 10 Top 10" (<http://www.afi.com/10top10/gangster.html>). *American Film Institute*. June 17, 2008. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130116145351/http://www.afi.com/10top10/gangster.html>) from the original on January 16, 2013. Retrieved June 18, 2008.
193. "AFI's 100 Years ... 100 Movies—10th Anniversary Edition" (<https://www.afi.com/afis-100-years-100-movies-10th-anniversary-edition/>). *American Film Institute*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20110716071157/http://connect.afi.com/site/PageServer?pagename=micro_100landing) from the original on July 16, 2011. Retrieved September 20, 2007.
194. "Best Movies of All Time" (<https://www.metacritic.com/browse/movies/score/metascore/all/filtered>). *Metacritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190102032945/https://www.metacritic.com/browse/movies/score/metascore/all/filtered>) from the original on January 2, 2019. Retrieved September 29, 2018.
195. "The 500 Greatest Movies Of All Time" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20131101010231/http://www.empireonline.com/500/94.asp>). *Empire*. September 2008. Archived from the original (<https://www.empireonline.com/500/94.asp>) on November 1, 2013. Retrieved December 13, 2008.
196. Mueller, Matt (October 17, 2006). "Total Film Presents The Top 100 Movies Of All Time" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080924181919/http://www.totalfilm.com/features/total_film_presents_the_top_100_movies_of_all_time). *Total Film*. Archived from the original (http://www.totalfilm.com/features/total_film_presents_the_top_100_movies_of_all_time) on September 24, 2008. Retrieved September 21, 2007.
197. "Star Wars Voted Best Film Ever" (<http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/entertainment/1676023.stm>). *BBC News*. November 26, 2001. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20090302155719/http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/entertainment/1676023.stm>) from the original on March 2, 2009. Retrieved September 14, 2007.
198. "100 Greatest American Films" (<https://www.bbc.com/culture/story/20150720-the-100-greatest-american-films>). *BBC*. July 20, 2015. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160916105535/http://www.bbc.com/culture/story/20150720-the-100-greatest-american-films>) from the original on September 16, 2016. Retrieved July 21, 2015.
199. Johnson, G. Allen (April 16, 2026). "Pete Hegseth cites 'Pulp Fiction' line as Bible verse at Pentagon prayer service" (<https://www.sfchronicle.com/entertainment/movies-tv/article/hegseth-pulp-fiction-bible-verse-22210954.php>). *San Francisco Chronicle*. Retrieved April 17, 2026.
200. "Pete Hegseth Recites Biblical 'Prayer' That's Actually a Pulp Fiction Quote" (<https://people.com/pete-hegseth-biblical-prayer-pulp-fiction-monologue-11951524>). 2026.
201. O'Brien 1994, pp. 90, 91.
202. O'Brien 1994, p. 91.
203. French, Philip (March 26, 2006). "Pulp Fiction" (<https://www.theguardian.com/theobserver/2006/mar/26/1>). *The Observer*. London. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160817181404/https://www.theguardian.com/theobserver/2006/mar/26/1>) from the original on August 17, 2016. Retrieved December 28, 2008.
204. Mottram 2006, p. 228, 77.
205. Martin Scorsese (guest host), Roger Ebert (host) (February 26, 2000). "Martin Scorsese's Best Films of the '90s". *Roger Ebert & the Movies*. Season 1. Episode 26.
206. Kolker 2000, p. 249.

207. Kolker 2000, p. 281.
208. Rubin 1999, p. 174.
209. Tarantino 1994, pp. 24, 27.
210. Conard 2006, p. 108.
211. Walker 2005, p. 315.
212. Hirsch 1997, pp. 360, 340.
213. Constable 2004, p. 54.
214. Conard 2006, p. 125.
215. Alleva, Richard (November 18, 1994). "Pulp Fiction" (https://web.archive.org/web/20071130072640/http://findarticles.com/p/articles/mi_m1252/is_n20_v121/ai_15879432/pg_1). *Commonweal*. Vol. 121, no. 20. Archived from the original on November 30, 2007. Retrieved October 8, 2007.
216. Stone, Alan (April–May 1995). "Pulp Fiction" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20070621100941/http://bostonreview.net/BR20.2/stone.html>). *Boston Review*. Archived from the original (<https://bostonreview.net/BR20.2/stone.html>) on June 21, 2007. Retrieved September 18, 2007.
217. Kolker 2000, pp. 249, 250.
218. Kolker 2000, p. 250.
219. Giroux 1996, p. 77.
220. Demory, Pamela H. (1995). "Violence and Transcendence in Pulp Fiction and Flannery O'Connor". In Wright, Will; Kaplan, Steven (eds.). *The Image of Violence in Literature, the Media, and Society: Selected Papers [from the] 1995 Conference of the Society for Interdisciplinary Study of Social Imagery*. Society for the Interdisciplinary Study of Social Imagery. Pueblo, CO. pp. 187–194.
221. Scott, R. Neil, ed. (2002). *Flannery O'Connor: An Annotated Reference Guide to Criticism*. Milledgeville, Georgia: Timberlane Books. p. 185. ISBN 978-0971542808.
222. Groth 1997, p. 189.
223. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 9, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
224. Charyn 2006, p. 106.
225. Tincknell 2006, p. 140.
226. Dawson 1995a, p. 178.
227. Polan 2000, p. 19.
228. White 2002, p. 342.
229. Fulwood 2003, p. 22.
230. Groth 1997, pp. 188–9.
231. Dinshaw 1997, p. 186.
232. Mottram 2006, pp. 75–76.
233. For Tarantino's admiration of Siegel, see Dawson (1995a, p. 142)
234. Bell 2000, p. 87.
235. Miller 1999, p. 76.
236. Giroux 1996, p. 78.
237. Groth 1997, p. 188.
238. Wild, David (November 3, 1994). "Quentin Tarantino: The Madman of Movie Mayhem" (<https://www.rollingstone.com/tv-movies/tv-movie-news/quentin-tarantino-the-madman-of-movie-mayhem-186995/>). *Rolling Stone*. p. 110. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220716045218/https://www.rollingstone.com/tv-movies/tv-movie-news/quentin-tarantino-the-madman-of-movie-mayhem-186995/>) from the original on July 16, 2022. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
239. Conard 2006, pp. 125, 133.
240. "Pulp Fiction (1994, part 4 of 5)" (<https://www.filmsite.org/pulp4.htmls>). *filmsite.org*.
241. Miklitsch 2006, pp. 15, 16: Note that while the Three Stooges did have an original TV series that ran briefly in the mid-1960s, they were most familiar from their cinematic shorts that were syndicated to television.
242. Miklitsch 2006, p. 16.
243. Willis 1997, p. 195.
244. Tarantino 1994, p. 28.

245. Gallafent 2006, p. 46.
246. "What's In the Briefcase?" (<http://www.snopes.com/movies/films/pulp.htm>). *Snopes.com*. August 17, 2007. Retrieved September 13, 2007.
247. "Rodriguez and Tarantino: Artist On Artist" (http://creative.myspace.com/groups/_mh/aoa/pages/qtarantino_rrodriguez/qtarantino_rrodriguez.html). *MySpace.com*. April 6, 2007. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20130120090140/http://creative.myspace.com/groups/_mh/aoa/pages/qtarantino_rrodriguez/qtarantino_rrodriguez.html) from the original on January 20, 2013. Retrieved September 13, 2007.
248. Polan 2000, p. 20.
249. "What's in the Briefcase in *Pulp Fiction*?" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20081120192104/http://www.straightdope.com/mailbag/mpulpfiction.html>). *The Straight Dope*. May 31, 2000. Archived from the original (<http://www.straightdope.com/mailbag/mpulpfiction.html>) on November 20, 2008. Retrieved September 18, 2007.
250. Cowen, Nick; Patience, Hari (August 16, 2008). "Wheels on Film: Repo Man" (<https://www.telegraph.co.uk/motoring/wheelsonfilm/2753942/Wheels-On-Film-Repo-Man.html>). *The Daily Telegraph*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180813111607/https://www.telegraph.co.uk/motoring/wheelsonfilm/2753942/Wheels-On-Film-Repo-Man.html>) from the original on August 13, 2018. Retrieved July 14, 2012.
251. Gormley 2005, p. 164.
252. Ebert 1997, p. 188.
253. Reinhartz 2003, p. 108.
254. "The Book of the Prophet Ezekiel, 25" (<http://www.bartleby.com/108/26/25.html>). *The Holy Bible: King James Version*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100131052531/http://www.bartleby.com/108/26/25.html>) from the original on January 31, 2010. Retrieved September 13, 2007 – via Bartleby.
255. Thomas 2003, pp. 61–62: Thomas notes that instead of "the Lord", this version reads "... and they shall know that I am Chiba the Bodyguard ...".
256. Conard 2006, p. 134: Conard claims that the text originates from the film *Bodigaado Kiba* (*Bodyguard Kiba* or *The Bodyguard*; 1973) and that the end phrase there is "And you will know my name is Chiba the Bodyguard ...".
257. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 4, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
258. Enhanced Trivia Track, ch. 25, *Pulp Fiction* DVD (Buena Vista Home Entertainment).
259. Gormley 2005, p. 167.
260. Reinhartz 2003, pp. 106, 107.
261. Conard 2006, p. 130.
262. White, Mike & Thompson, Mike (Spring 1995). "Tarantino in a Can?" (https://web.archive.org/web/20120211214336/http://www.impossiblefunky.com/archives/issue_2/2_toilet.asp?IshNum=2&Headline=Tarantino%20In%20The%20Can). *Cashiers du Cinemart*. Archived from the original (http://www.impossiblefunky.com/archives/issue_2/2_toilet.asp?IshNum=2&Headline=Tarantino%20In%20The%20Can) on February 11, 2012. Retrieved December 31, 2006.
263. Fraiman 2003, p. 15.
264. Brooker & Brooker 1996, p. 239.
265. Fraiman 2003, p. 14: Fraiman's identification of the submachine gun as a Czech M61 matches the description in the screenplay: Tarantino (1994), p. 96. Visual evidence suggests that a different gun was actually used in the film, possibly a MAC-10 or similar model.
266. "Awards Search/*Pulp Fiction*" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20070807063318/http://www1.hfpa.org/browse/film/24792>). Hollywood Foreign Press Association. Archived from the original (<http://www.hfpa.org/browse/film/24792>) on August 7, 2007. Retrieved September 12, 2007.
267. "AFI's 100 Years...100 Movies" (<https://www.afi.com/afis-100-years-100-movies/>). *AFI*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200422032506/https://www.afi.com/afis-100-years-100-movies/>) from the original on April 22, 2020. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
268. "AFI's 100 Years...100 Laughs Nominees" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110313150538/https://www.afi.com/Docs/100Years/laughs500.pdf>) (PDF). *AFI*. Archived from the original (<https://www.afi.com/Docs/100Years/laughs500.pdf>) (PDF) on March 13, 2011. Retrieved May 21, 2023.

269. "AFI's 100 Years...100 Thrills" (<https://www.afi.com/afis-100-years-100-thrills/>). *AFI*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210309023411/https://www.afi.com/afis-100-years-100-thrills/>) from the original on March 9, 2021. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
270. "AFI's 100 Years...100 Heroes & Villains Nominees" (<https://prdaficalmjedwestussa.blob.core.windows.net/images/2019/08/handv400.pdf>) (PDF). *AFI*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230521051036/https://prdaficalmjedwestussa.blob.core.windows.net/images/2019/08/handv400.pdf>) (PDF) from the original on May 21, 2023. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
271. "AFI's 100 Years...100 Quotes Nominees" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110313150620/http://www.afi.com/Docs/100Years/quotes400.pdf>) (PDF). *AFI*. Archived from the original (<http://www.afi.com/Docs/100Years/quotes400.pdf>) (PDF) on March 13, 2011. Retrieved May 21, 2023.
272. "'PULP FICTION': DON'T WATCH IT JUST ONE TIME" (<https://scholar.lib.vt.edu/VA-news/VA-Pilot/issues/1995/vp950912/09120038.htm>). *scholar.lib.vt.edu*.
273. "VHS Pulp Fiction New Sealed" (<https://www.quentintarantinofanclub.com/?p=shop&m=fp&idp=10&rsltid=AfmBOoq3IEy-Lxwx6GKkRMhNHL6phPpxKbdFKi4SnGva6UynzUgP4U3c>). *Quentin Tarantino Fan Club*.
274. "PULP FICTION - SPECIAL COLLECTOR'S EDITION" (<https://www.classification.gov.au/titles/pulp-fiction-special-collectors-edition>). *Classification.gov.au*. Retrieved June 9, 2026.
275. "LaserDisc Database - Search - Pulp Fiction" (<https://www.lddb.com/search.php?search=Pulp+Fiction&sort=title>). *Lddb.com*.
276. Conrad, Jeremy (August 9, 2002). "Pulp Fiction: DVD Collector's Edition Review" (<https://www.ign.com/articles/2002/08/09/pulp-fiction-collectors-edition>). *IGN*.
277. "DVD Talk" (<https://www.dvdtalk.com/reviews/4409/pulp-fiction-collectors-edition/>). *Dvdtalk.com*.
278. "Disney Completes Sale Of Miramax Films To Filmyard Holdings LLC" (<https://thewaltdisneycompany.com/disney-completes-sale-of-miramax-films-to-filmyard-holdings-llc/>). *The Walt Disney Company*. December 3, 2010. Retrieved August 26, 2025.
279. Teather, David (July 30, 2010). "Disney sells Miramax to investment group for \$660m" (<https://www.theguardian.com/business/2010/jul/30/film-industry-privateequity>). *The Guardian*.
280. Block, Alex Ben (February 17, 2011). "Echo Bridge to Distribute Miramax Titles on DVD, Blu-Ray" (<https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/echo-bridge-distribute-miramax-titles-101170/>). *The Hollywood Reporter*.
281. "Pulp Fiction DVD Release Date" ([https://www.dvdsreleasedates.com/movies/1837/Pulp-Fiction-\(1994\).html](https://www.dvdsreleasedates.com/movies/1837/Pulp-Fiction-(1994).html)). *DVDs Release Dates*.
282. "Pulp Fiction Blu-ray" (<https://www.blu-ray.com/movies/Pulp-Fiction-Blu-ray/3637/>). *Blu-ray.com*.
283. "Pulp Fiction BluRay - The Quentin Tarantino Archives" (https://wiki.tarantino.info/index.php/Pulp_Fiction_BluRay). *wiki.tarantino.info*.
284. "Miramax Deal With Netflix Ends on June 1st - Over 400 Movies Leaving" (<https://www.whats-on-netflix.com/leaving-soon/miramax-deal-with-netflix-ends-on-june-1st-over-400-movies-leaving/>). *What's on Netflix*. May 21, 2016.
285. Smith, Nigel M. (March 2, 2016). "Iconic film studio Miramax sells to Doha-based beIN Media Group" (<https://www.theguardian.com/film/2016/mar/02/bein-media-group-miramax-film-studio-acquisition>). *The Guardian*.
286. Szalai, Georg (April 3, 2020). "ViacomCBS Closes Acquisition of 49 Percent Miramax Stake in \$375 Million Deal" (<https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/viacomcbs-closes-acquisition-miramax-stake-375-million-deal-1286478/>) – via The Hollywood Reporter.
287. D'Alessandro, Anthony (December 20, 2019). "ViacomCBS Taking 49% Stake In Miramax For \$375M" (<https://deadline.com/2019/12/viacom-miramax-library-talks-resume-1202805735/>).
288. Salkowitz, Rob. "ViacomCBS Adds To Media Portfolio, Taking 49% Stake In Miramax" (<https://www.forbes.com/sites/robsalkowitz/2020/04/03/viacomcbs-adds-to-media-portfolio-taking-49-stake-in-miramax/>). *Forbes*.
289. "Pulp Fiction" (<https://parkcircus.com/film/107474-Pulp-Fiction>). *Park Circus*.
290. Vlessing, Etan (April 11, 2024). "Neal H. Moritz, Paramount Renew First Look Production Deal" (<https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/neal-mortiz-paramount-first-look-deal-1235871980/>). *The Hollywood Reporter*.
291. "Pulp Fiction Blu-ray (Blu-ray + Digital HD)" (<https://www.blu-ray.com/movies/Pulp-Fiction-Blu-ray/274484/>). *Blu-ray.com*.

292. Cole, Chris Cabin, Jake (December 7, 2022). "'Pulp Fiction' 4K UHD Blu-ray Review" (<https://www.slantmagazine.com/dvd/pulp-fiction-4k-uhd-blu-ray-review-quentin-tarantino/>). *Slant Magazine*.
293. "Pulp Fiction 4K Blu-ray (30th Anniversary Collector's Edition) (United Kingdom)" (<https://www.blu-ray.com/movies/Pulp-Fiction-4K-Blu-ray/372011/>). *Blu-ray.com*.
294. Member, Samuel Spencer Newsweek Is A. Trust Project (March 4, 2021). "All the Shows and Movies Streaming Now on Paramount+" (<https://www.newsweek.com/paramount-plus-line-tv-shows-films-movies-1573726>). *Newsweek*.
295. Meilstrup, Adam (July 27, 2024). "Quentin Tarantino's Most Iconic Film Finds a New Streaming Home in August" (<https://www.cbr.com/quentin-tarantino-pulp-fiction-paramount-plus/>). *CBR*.
296. Schonger, Allison (August 20, 2025). "Pluto TV Is Now Streaming One of the Best Movies of All-Time" (<https://comicbook.com/movies/news/pluto-tv-movies-streaming-pulp-fiction-best-movie-all-time/>).
297. Diaz, Johnny (November 17, 2021). "Miramax Sues Quentin Tarantino Over Planned 'Pulp Fiction' NFTs" (<https://ghostarchive.org/archive/20211228/https://www.nytimes.com/2021/11/17/business/miramax-tarantino-nft-pulp-fiction.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Archived from the original (<https://www.nytimes.com/2021/11/17/business/miramax-tarantino-nft-pulp-fiction.html>) on December 28, 2021. Retrieved November 17, 2021.
298. "Quentin Tarantino sued over 'Pulp Fiction' NFT plan" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211117221449/https://news.yahoo.com/quentin-tarantino-sued-over-pulp-214715919.html>). *news.yahoo.com*. November 17, 2021. Archived from the original (<https://news.yahoo.com/quentin-tarantino-sued-over-pulp-214715919.html>) on November 17, 2021. Retrieved November 17, 2021.
299. Maddaus, Gene (September 9, 2022). "Quentin Tarantino Settles With Miramax Over 'Pulp Fiction' NFT Auction" (<https://variety.com/2022/film/news/quentin-tarantino-miramax-pulp-fiction-nft-settlement-1235365550/>). *Variety*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220925063120/https://variety.com/2022/film/news/quentin-tarantino-miramax-pulp-fiction-nft-settlement-1235365550/>) from the original on September 25, 2022. Retrieved September 25, 2022.

Bibliography

- Bailey, Jason (2013). *Pulp Fiction: The Complete Story of Quentin Tarantino's Masterpiece*. Voyageur Press. ISBN 978-0-7603-4479-8.
- Barker, Martin; Austin, Thomas (2000). *From Antz to Titanic: Reinventing Film Analysis*. Pluto Press. ISBN 0-7453-1579-8.
- Bart, Peter (2000). *The Gross: The Hits, the Flops—The Summer That Ate Hollywood*. New York: St. Martin's. ISBN 0-312-25391-5.
- Bell, David (2000). "Eroticizing the Rural". In Shuttleton, David; Watt, Diane; Phillips, Richard (eds.). *De-Centering Sexualities: Politics and Representations Beyond the Metropolis*. London and New York: Routledge. ISBN 0-415-19466-0.
- Biskind, Peter (2004). *Down and Dirty Pictures: Miramax, Sundance, and the Rise of Independent Film* (https://archive.org/details/isbn_9780965931571). New York: Simon & Schuster. ISBN 0-684-86259-X.
- Brooker, Peter; Brooker, Will (1996). "Pulpmodernism: Tarantino's Affirmative Action". In Simpson, Philip; Utterson, Andrew; Shepherdson, Karen J. (eds.). *Film Theory: Critical Concepts in Media and Cultural Studies*. London and New York: Routledge. ISBN 0-415-25971-1.
- Charyn, Jerome (2006). *Raised by Wolves: The Turbulent Art and Times of Quentin Tarantino*. New York: Thunder's Mouth Press. ISBN 1-56025-858-6.
- Christopher, Nicholas (2006). *Somewhere in the Night: Film Noir and the American City*. Emeryville, Calif.: Shoemaker & Hoard. ISBN 1-59376-097-3.
- Conard, Mark T. (2006). "Symbolism, Meaning, and Nihilism in *Pulp Fiction*". *The Philosophy of Film Noir*. Lexington: University Press of Kentucky. ISBN 0-8131-2377-1.
- Constable, Catherine (2004). "Postmodernism and Film". In Connor, Steven (ed.). *The Cambridge Companion to Postmodernism*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. ISBN 0-521-64840-8.
- Dancyger, Ken (2002). *The Technique of Film and Video Editing: History, Theory, and Practice* (3rd ed.). New York: Focal Press. ISBN 0-240-80420-1.

- Dargis, Manohla (1994a). "Pulp Instincts" (https://archive.org/details/Sight_and_Sound_1994_05_BFI_GB/page/n7/mode/2up). *Sight and Sound*. Vol. 4, no. 5. pp. 6–11. collected in Peary, Gerald, ed. (1998). *Quentin Tarantino: Interviews*. Jackson: University Press of Mississippi. ISBN 1-57806-051-6.
- Dargis, Manohla (1994b). "Quentin Tarantino on *Pulp Fiction*". *Sight and Sound*. Vol. 4, no. 11.
- Davis, Todd F.; Womack, Kenneth (1998). "Shepherding the Weak: The Ethics of Redemption in Quentin Tarantino's *Pulp Fiction*". *Literature/Film Quarterly*. **26** (1).
- Dawson, Jeff (1995a). *Quentin Tarantino: The Cinema of Cool*. New York and London: Applause. ISBN 1-55783-227-7.
- Desser, David (2003). "Global Noir: Genre Film in the Age of Transnationalism". In Grant, Barry Keith (ed.). *Film Genre Reader III*. Austin: University of Texas Press. ISBN 0-292-70185-3.
- Dinshaw, Carolyn (1997). "Getting Medieval: *Pulp Fiction*, Gawain, Foucault". In Frese, Dolores Warwick; O'Keeffe, Katherine O'Brien (eds.). *The Book and the Body*. Notre Dame: University of Notre Dame Press. ISBN 0-268-00700-4.
- Ebert, Roger (1997). *Questions for the Movie Answer Man*. Kansas City, Mo.: Andrews McMeel. ISBN 0-8362-2894-4.
- Fraiman, Susan (2003). *Cool Men and the Second Sex*. New York: Columbia University Press. ISBN 0-231-12962-9.
- Fulwood, Neil (2003). *One Hundred Violent Films that Changed Cinema*. London and New York: Batsford/Sterling. ISBN 0-7134-8819-0.
- Gallafent, Edward (2006). *Quentin Tarantino*. London: Pearson Longman. ISBN 0-582-47304-7.
- Giroux, Henry A. (1996). *Fugitive Cultures: Race, Violence, and Youth*. London and New York: Routledge. ISBN 0-415-91577-5.
- Gormley, Paul (2005). *The New-Brutality Film: Race and Affect in Contemporary Hollywood Cinema*. Bristol, UK, and Portland, Ore.: Intellect. ISBN 1-84150-119-0.
- Groth, Gary (1997). "A Dream of Perfect Reception: The Movies of Quentin Tarantino". In Frank, Thomas; Weiland, Matt (eds.). *Commodify Your Dissent: Salvos from The Baffler*. New York: W.W. Norton. ISBN 0-393-31673-4.
- Hirsch, Foster (1997). "Afterword". In Clarens, Carlos (ed.). *Crime Movies* (revised ed.). Cambridge, Mass.: Da Capo. ISBN 0-306-80768-8.
- Hoffman, David (2005). *The Breakfast Cereal Gourmet*. Kansas City, Mo.: Andrews McMeel. ISBN 0-7407-5029-1.
- King, Geoff (2002). *Film Comedy*. London: Wallflower Press. ISBN 1-903364-35-3.
- Kolker, Robert (2000). *A Cinema of Loneliness: Penn, Stone, Kubrick, Scorsese, Spielberg, Altman*. New York: Oxford University Press. ISBN 0-19-512350-6.
- Miklitsch, Robert (2006). *Roll Over Adorno: Critical Theory, Popular Culture, Audiovisual Media* (<http://books.google.com/books?id=oCprHBiGYoMC&pg=PA15>). SUNY Press. ISBN 978-0791467343.
- Miller, Stephen Paul (1999). *The Seventies Now: Culture As Surveillance*. Durham, N.C: Duke University Press. ISBN 0-8223-2166-1.
- Mottram, James (2006). *The Sundance Kids: How the Mavericks Took Back Hollywood*. New York: Macmillan. ISBN 0-571-22267-6.
- O'Brien, Geoffrey (1994). "Quentin Tarantino's Pulp Fantastic". *Castaways of the Image Planet: Movies, Show Business, Public Spectacle*. Washington, D.C.: Counterpoint. ISBN 1-58243-190-6.
- Parker, Philip (2002). *The Art and Science of Screenwriting* (2nd ed.). Bristol, UK: Intellect. ISBN 1-84150-065-8.
- Polan, Dana (2000). *Pulp Fiction*. London: BFI. ISBN 0-85170-808-0.
- Rabinowitz, Paula (2002). *Black & White & Noir: America's Pulp Modernism*. New York: Columbia University Press. ISBN 0-231-11480-X.
- Real, Michael R. (1996). *Exploring Media Culture: A Guide*. Thousand Oaks, Calif., London, and New Delhi: Sage. ISBN 0-8039-5877-3.
- Reinhartz, Adele (2003). *Scripture on the Silver Screen*. Louisville: Westminster John Knox Press. ISBN 0-664-22359-1.
- Rubin, Martin (1999). *Thrillers*. Cambridge, New York, and Melbourne: Cambridge University Press. ISBN 0-521-58839-1.

- Silver, Alain; Ursini, James (2004). *Film Noir*. Cologne: Taschen. ISBN 3-8228-2261-2.
- Tarantino, Quentin (1994). *Pulp Fiction: A Screenplay*. New York: Hyperion/Miramax. ISBN 0-7868-8104-6.
- Thomas, Brian (2003). *VideoHound's Dragon: Asian Action & Cult Flicks*. Canton, Mich.: Visible Ink Press. ISBN 1-57859-141-4.
- Tincknell, Estella (2006). "The Soundtrack Movie, Nostalgia and Consumption". In Conrich, Ian; Tincknell, Estella (eds.). *Film's Musical Moments*. Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press. ISBN 0-7486-2344-2.
- Walker, David (2005). "Tarantino, Quentin". In Sim, Stuart (ed.). *The Routledge Companion to Postmodernism* (2nd ed.). London and New York: Routledge. ISBN 0-415-33358-X.
- Waxman, Sharon (2005). *Rebels on the Backlot: Six Maverick Directors and How They Conquered the Hollywood Studio System* (<https://archive.org/details/rebelsonbacklots00waxm>). New York: HarperCollins. ISBN 0-06-054017-6.
- White, Glyn (2002). "Quentin Tarantino". In Tasker, Yvonne (ed.). *Fifty Contemporary Filmmakers*. London and New York: Routledge. ISBN 0-415-18973-X.
- Willis, Sharon (1997). *High Contrast: Race and Gender in Contemporary Hollywood Film*. Durham, N.C.: Duke University Press. ISBN 0-8223-2041-X.

External links

- *Pulp Fiction* essay (<https://www.loc.gov/static/programs/national-film-preservation-board/documents/pulp%20fiction.pdf>) by Jami Bernard at National Film Registry
 - Official website (<http://www.miramax.com/movie/pulp-fiction>) 
 - *Pulp Fiction* (<https://catalog.afi.com/Catalog/moviedetails/55207>) at the *AFI Catalog of Feature Films*
 - *Pulp Fiction* (<https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0110912/>) at IMDb
 - *Pulp Fiction* bibliography (via UC Berkeley) (<http://www.lib.berkeley.edu/MRC/tarantino.html#pulp>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100622013802/http://www.lib.berkeley.edu/MRC/tarantino.html#pulp>) June 22, 2010, at the Wayback Machine
 - Discussion of *Pulp Fiction* use of Ezekiel 25:17 at Bibledex.com (http://www.bibledex.com/verses/pulp_fiction.html)
-

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Pulp_Fiction&oldid=1370760138"